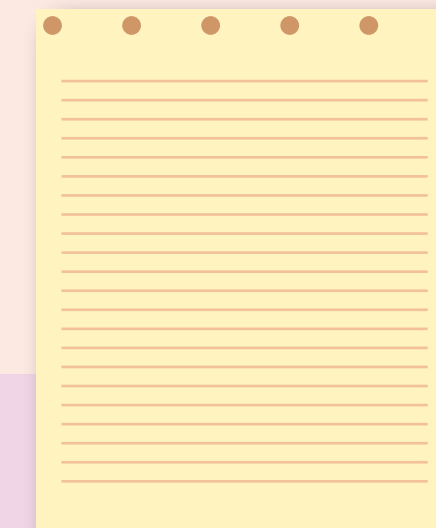


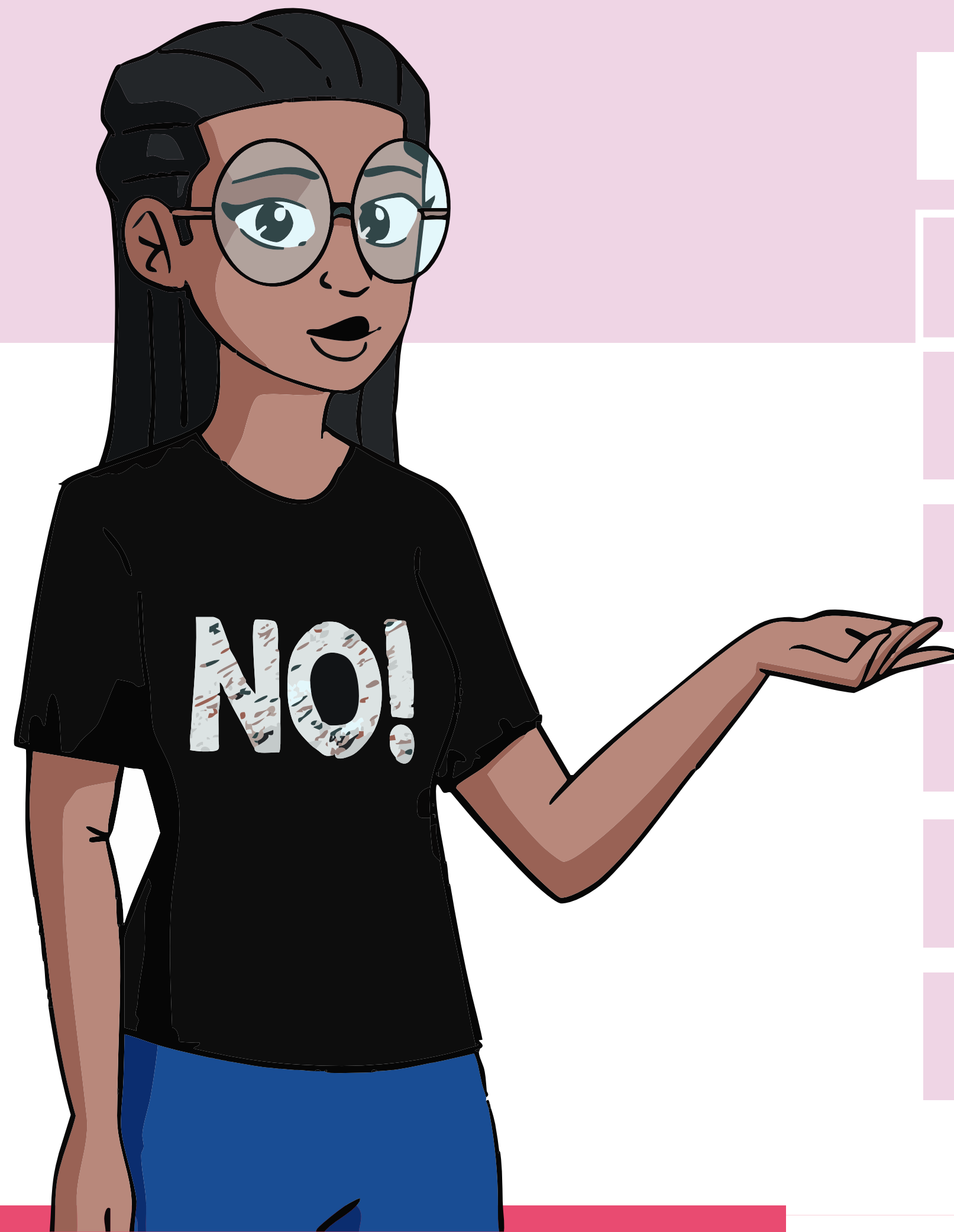
Girls Empowerment Self Defense (GESD)



**Hello! I'm Tatenda from Ujamaa Africa. This is a safe space to learn and share.
No wrong answers, and our discussion stays here.
Let's get started!**



Let's set some ground rules to keep this **space safe, respectful, and supportive for everyone.**



Respect Everyone – Every opinion matters.

Stay Focused – Avoid distractions.

Safe Space – If you need to step out, that's okay.

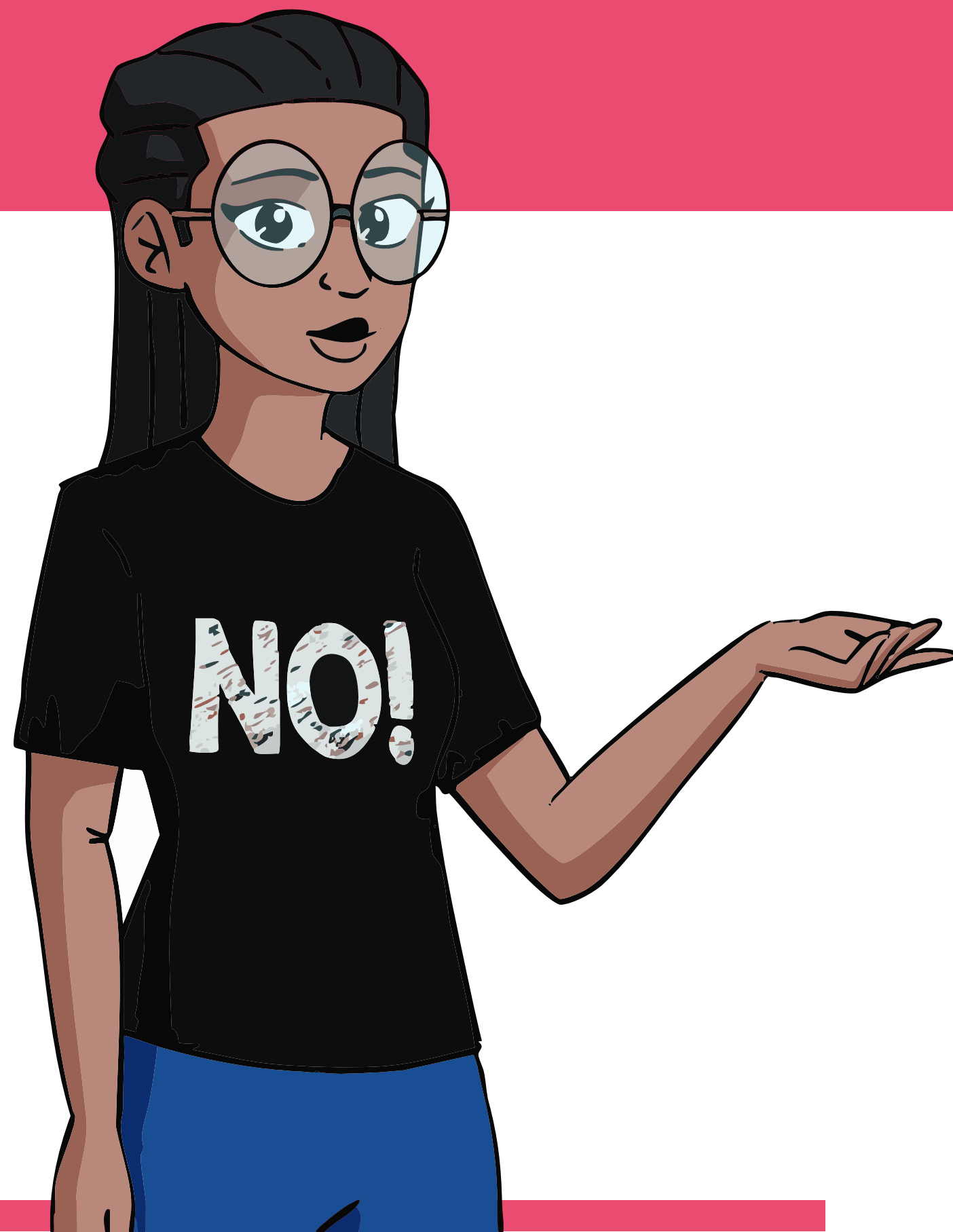
No Victim Blaming – The attack was not your fault.

Be Safe – If an activity isn't safe for you, don't do it.

Confidentiality – Personal stories stay in class.

No Fighting – What we learn is for protection only.

**“ If this session feels overwhelming, you’re free to take a break.
And if you ever need to talk, we’re here for you.”**



**We Are In This
Together.**



SESSION 1

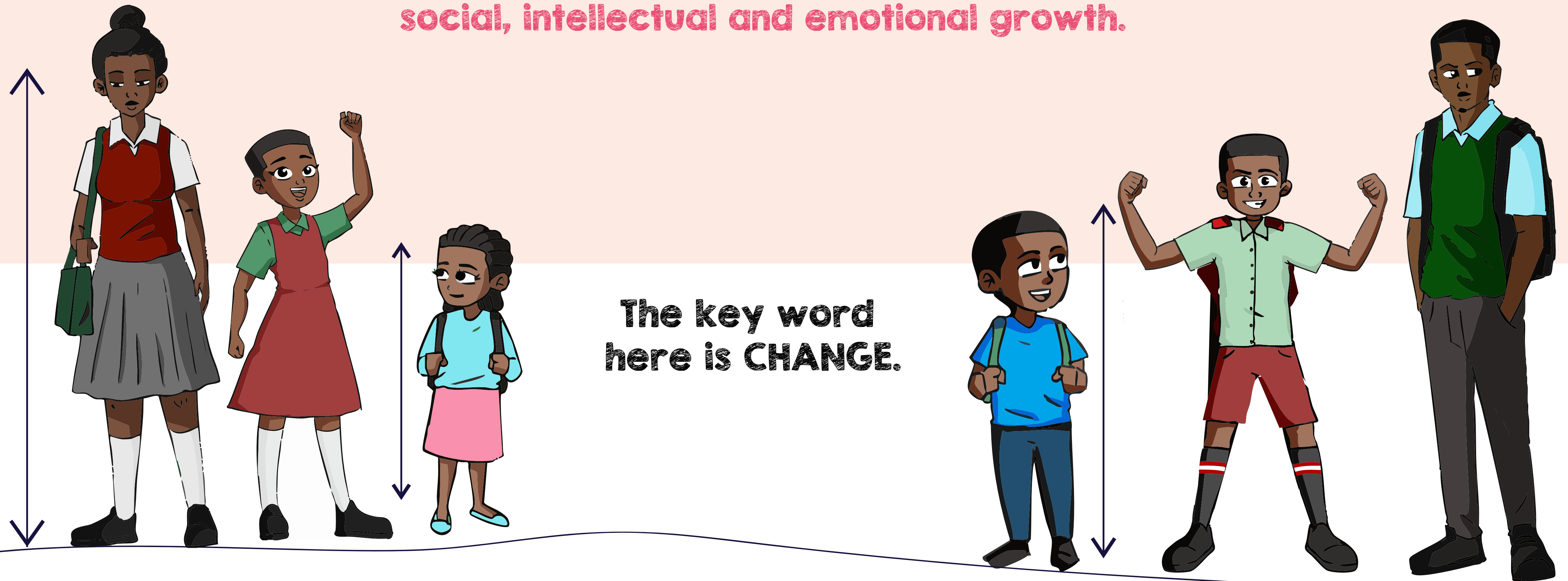
**Today, we will talk about puberty, menstruation, and hygiene
what's true and what's not about puberty. Let's learn together!**



Puberty

This is a period of **transition from childhood to adulthood.**

During this period, boys and girls experience **physical, behavioral, cognitive, social, intellectual and emotional growth.**



What changes occur in the body during puberty in Girls and Boys?



GIRLS	BOYS
Skin may become oilier	Deeper Voice
Hair grows (under the arms)	Hair Growth (face, chest)
Girls grow taller	Boys grow taller and Strong
Breasts start to develop	The penis and testes get bigger
Hips get broader	Shoulders get broader
Girls begin menstruating	Sperm Production

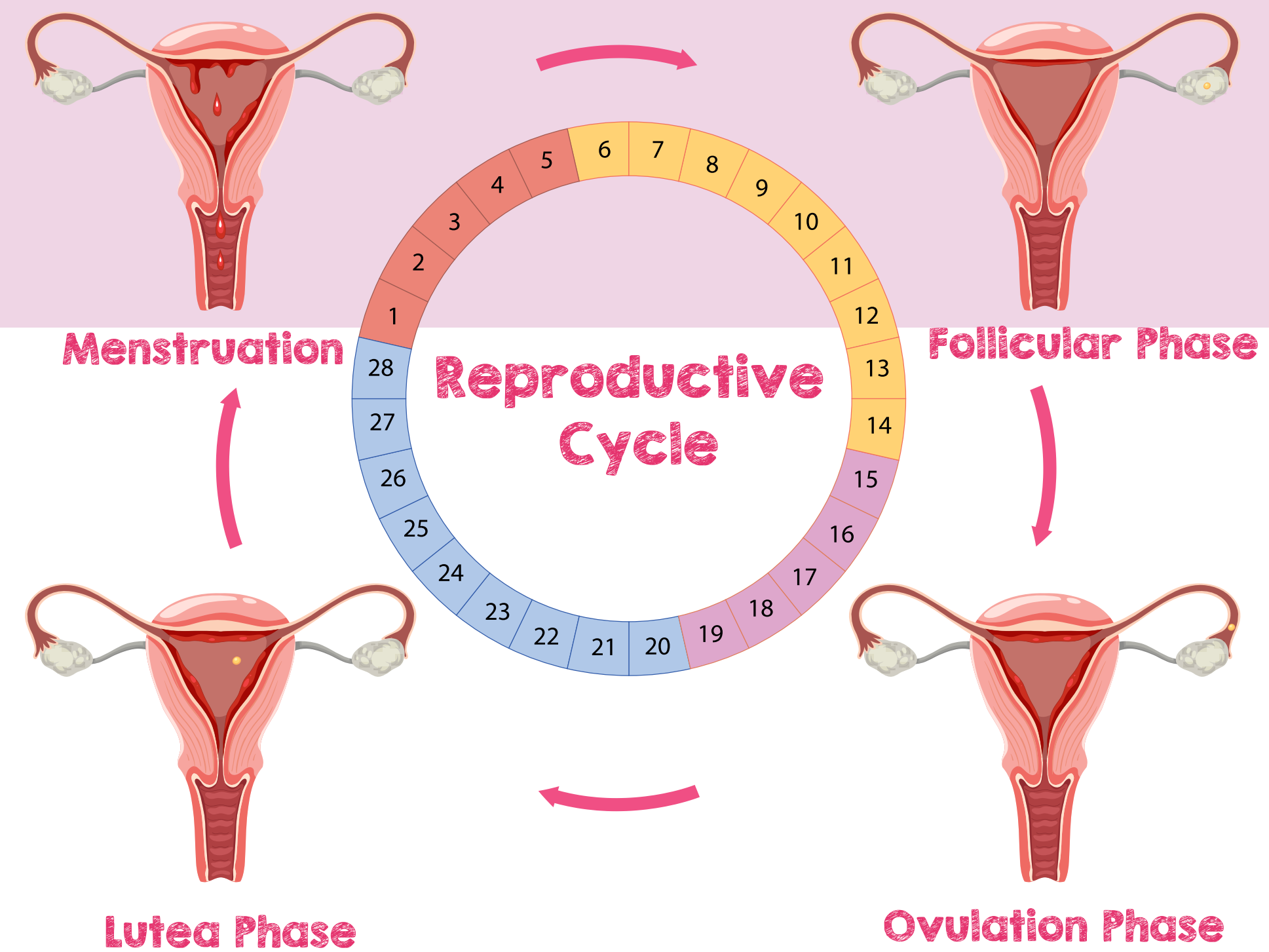


During this period observe proper hygiene.

Menstrual Health

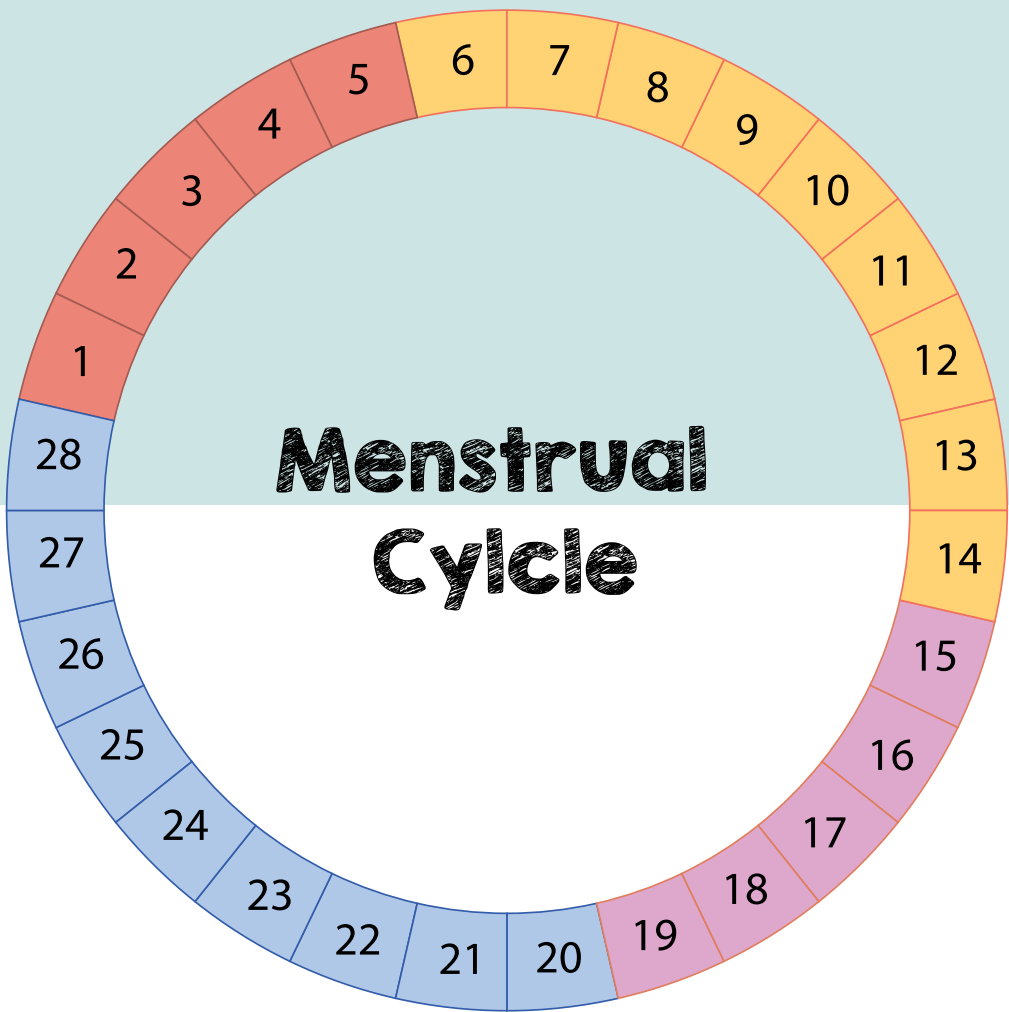
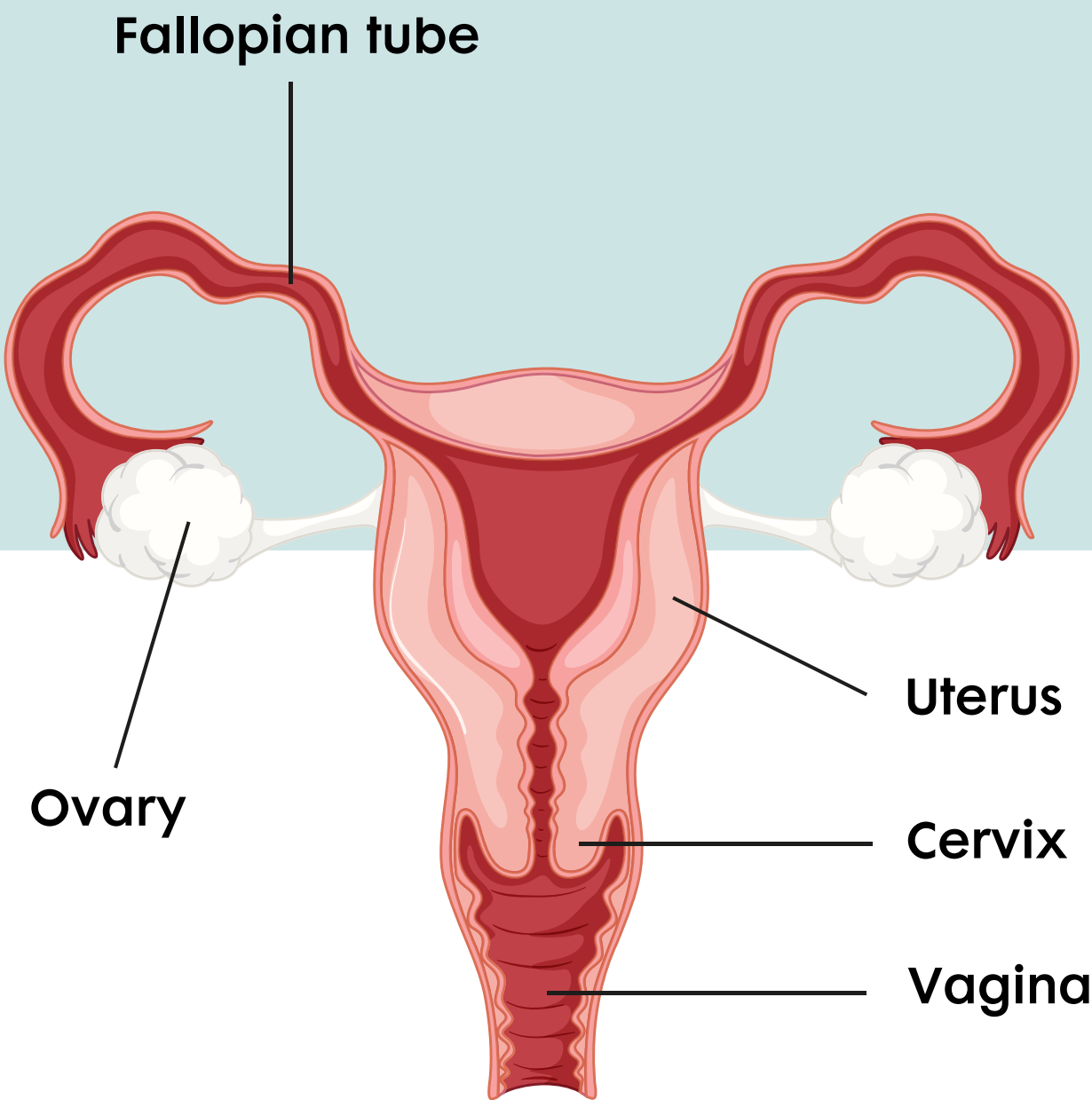
One of the important changes that girls go through is menstruation, which is a natural process of the **female's reproductive cycle**

Once the menstruation starts each month thereafter one of her ovaries releases an egg (Ovum).



Menstrual Cycle

The length of the menstrual cycles varies from girl to girl, most women and girls have their periods every 28 days. Regular cycles that are longer or shorter than this from 21 days to 35 days are normal.



Personal Hygiene

**It is important to ensure that your body is clean to avoid illness and diseases.
During this time girls should:**

**Bathe daily with soap and water
(morning and evening if possible).**

**Keep unused clothes and pads
clean for futher use.**

**Pat the vagina dry with a cloth and
put a fresh cloth, pad, or cotton
on your underwear.**

**Always wipe from front to back after
a long call.**

**Wash the vagina with water only
(don't use soap).**



SESSION 1

Getting To Know You

Today, we will interact and know each other better through the questions. This is a safe space for all of us.



0.1 Who am I?

0.2 What are you good at?

0.3 What are some good or bad companies you know?

0.4 How do you spend your weekend?

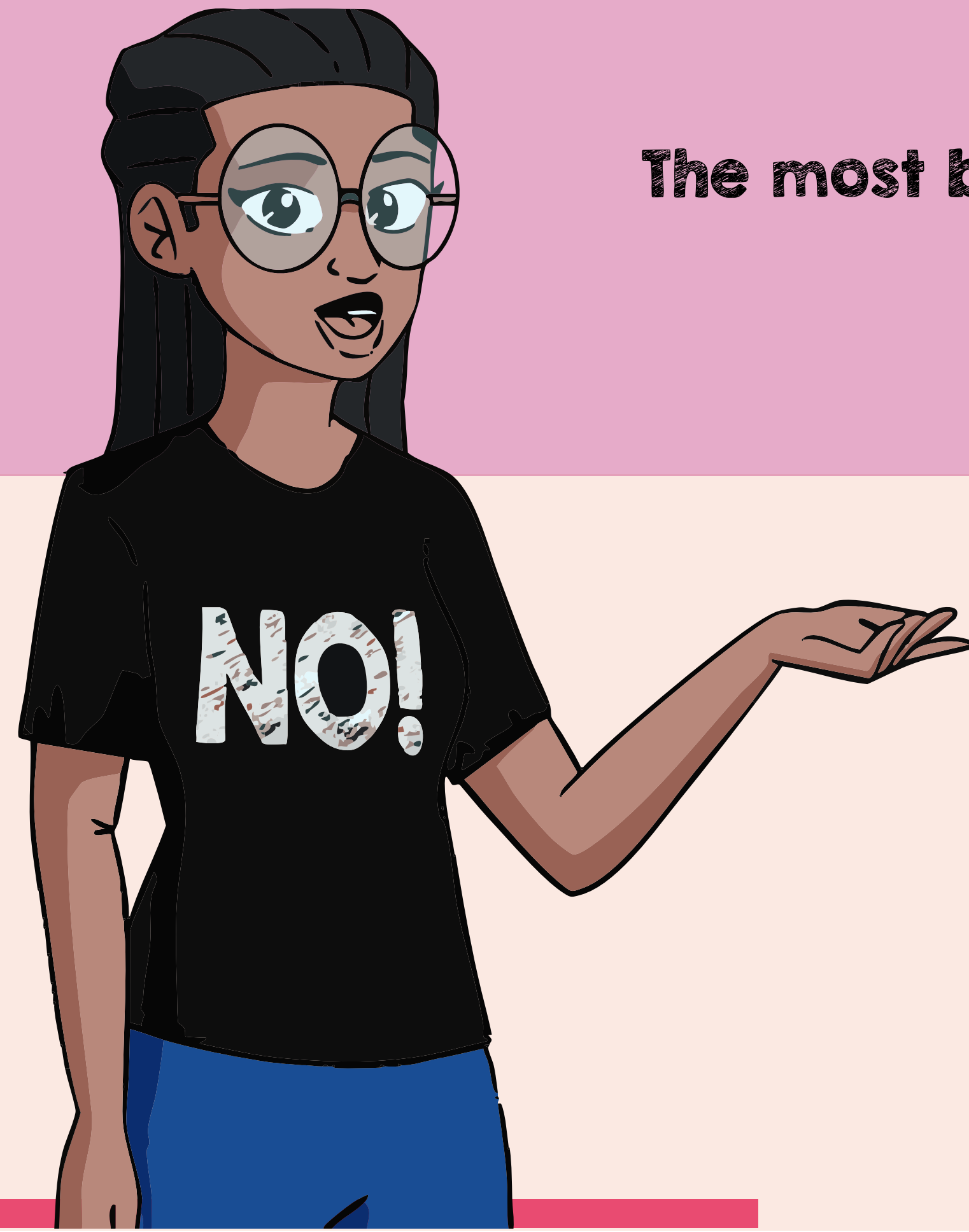
0.5 What topics do you usually discuss with fellow girls?

SESSION 2

Girls Empowerment Self-Defense (GESD)

This is the foundation on which all safety strategies are built on, these strategies are trained to girls and women, who are at a very high risk of Sexual assault.

**The most basic goal of GESD is to get to safety.
To get free.**



**The Aim is to
Get away.**



Three Components of GESD



Self-empowerment

Self-efficacy

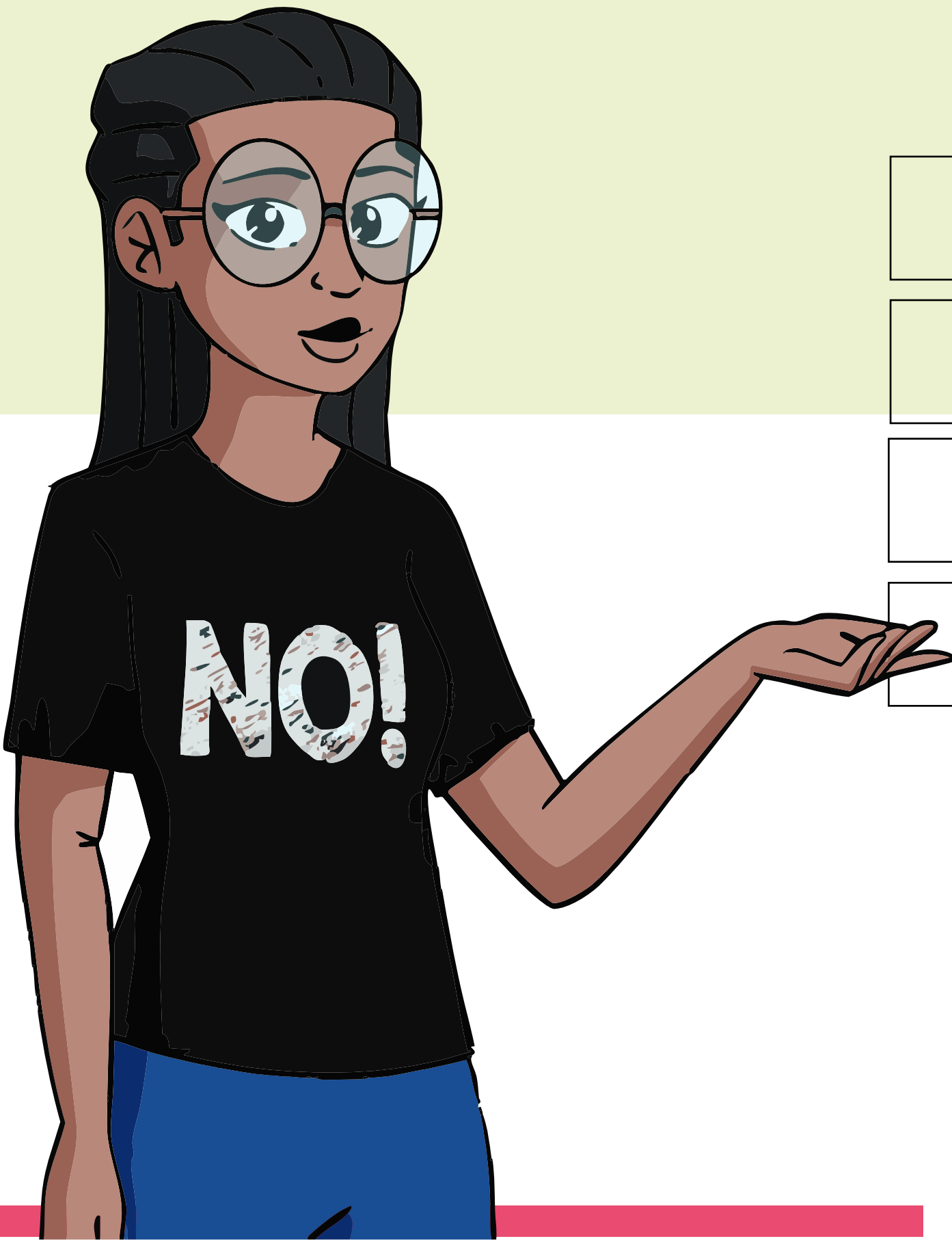
Self-defense



Self-empowerment

This is taking charge of our own life.

Taking charge of educational, health and safety goals. It means being assertive, speaking up for ourselves and holding beliefs that acknowledge our rights and capabilities.



- Not giving away power or accepting disrespect.
- Managing education, health, and security.
- Being assertive and speaking up.
- Believing in your rights and capabilities.



Women Assertive Bill Of Rights

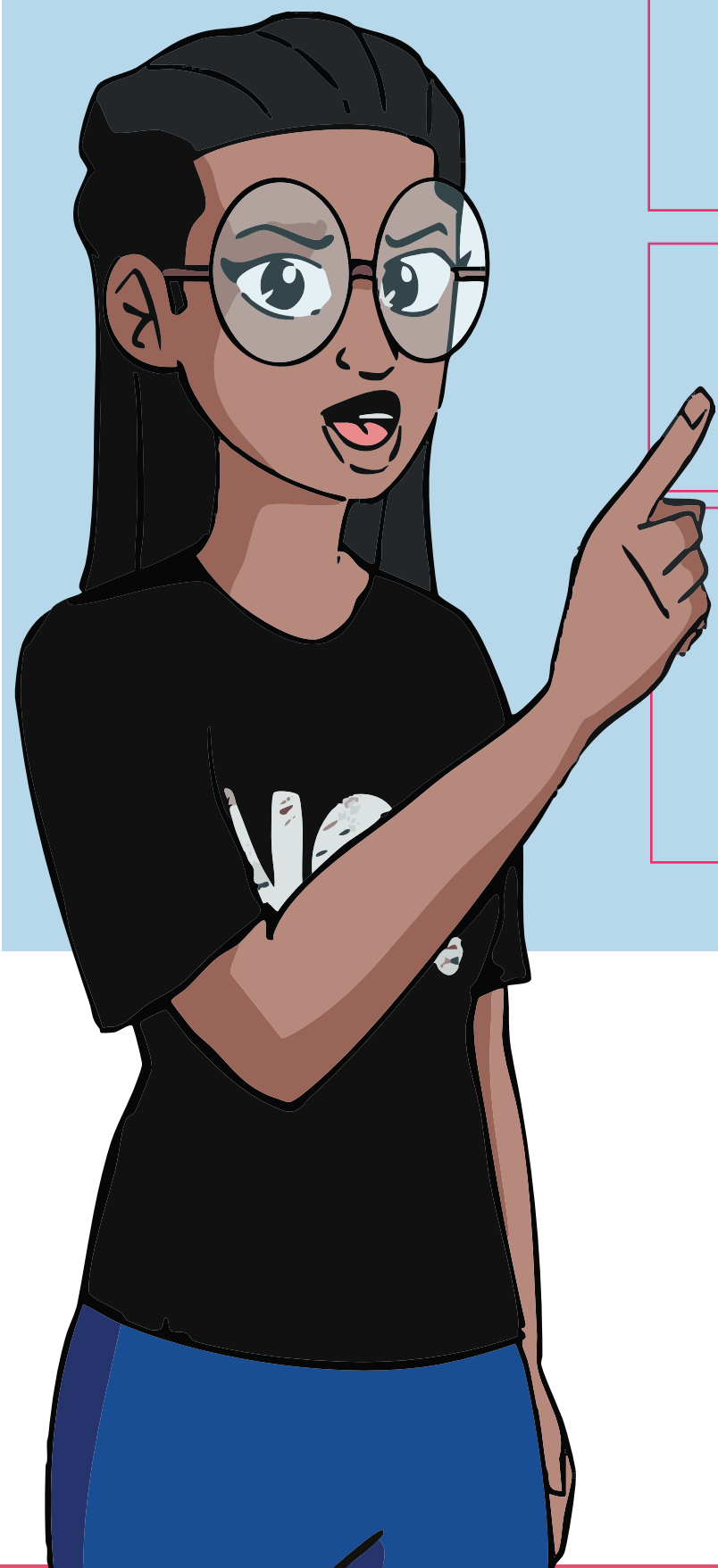
The Rights of EVERY girl in Malawi

Every girl has the right to say NO without feeling guilty.

Every girl has the right to be treated with respect.

Every girl has the right to say I don't understand.

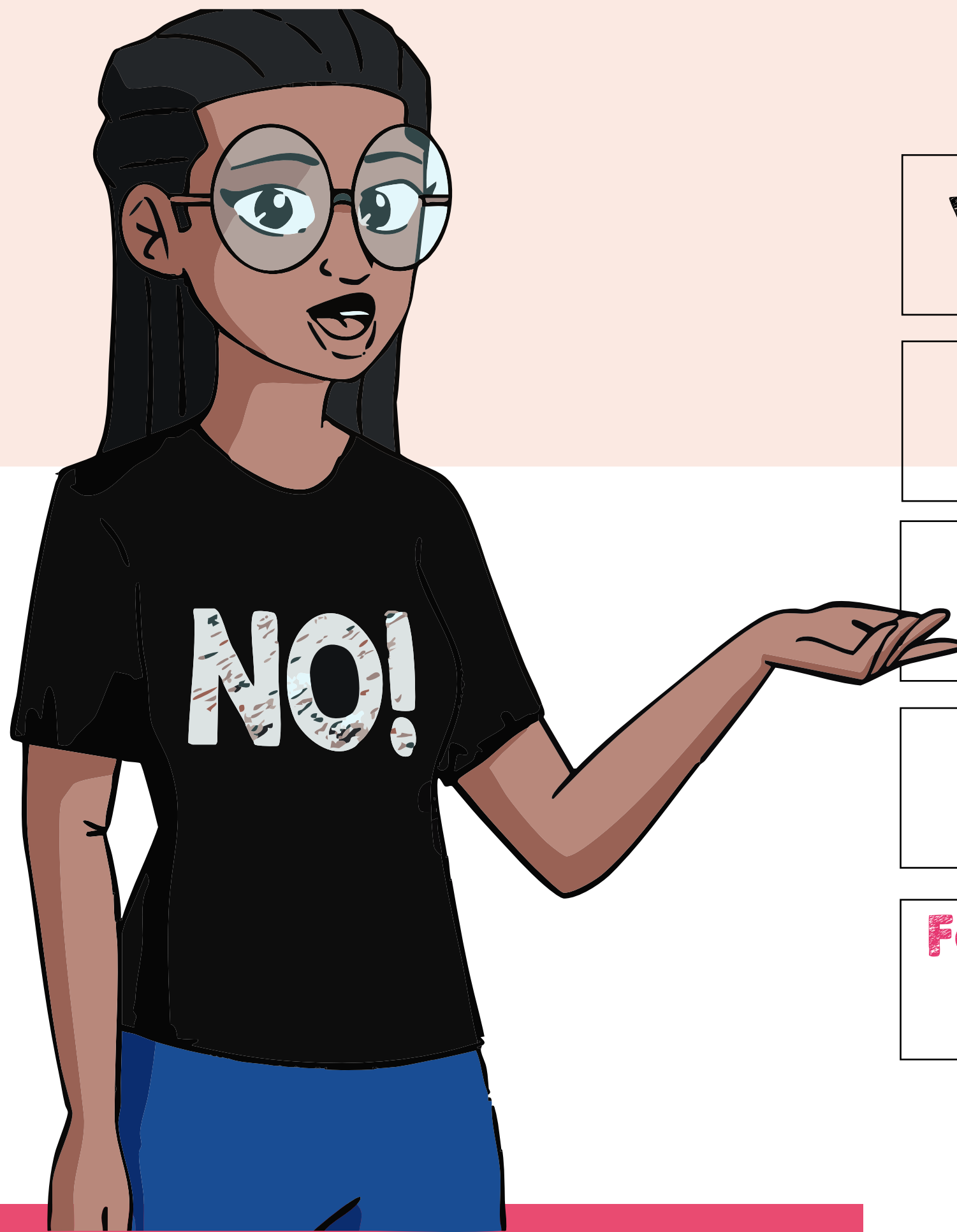
Every girl has the right to make mistakes and be responsible for them.



Self-efficacy

Self-efficacy is meeting life's challenges and being able to overcome.

A person with strong self-efficacy is able to: Believe in themselves and have the ability to master life challenges.



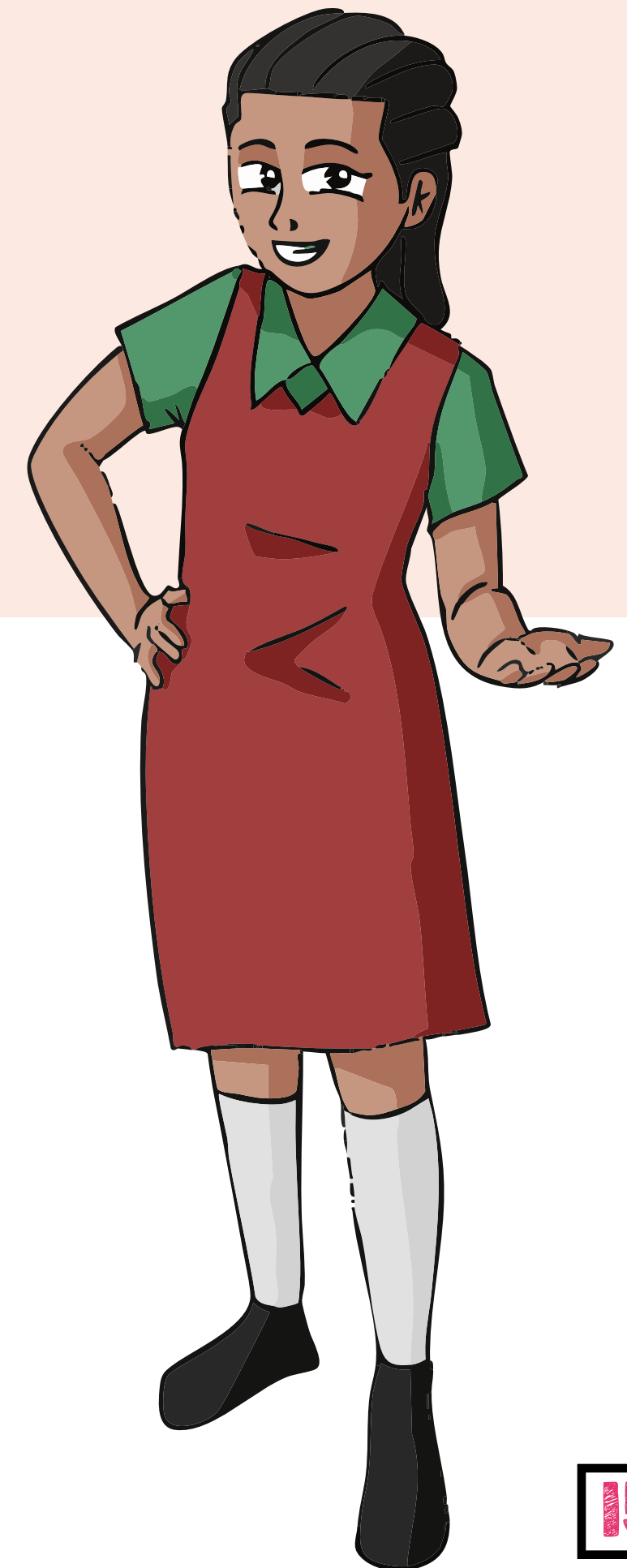
View challenging problems as tasks to be mastered

Develop deeper interest in the activities in which they participate

Develop deeper interest in the activities in which they participate

Recover quickly from setbacks and disappointment

Form a strong sense of commitment to their interests and activities



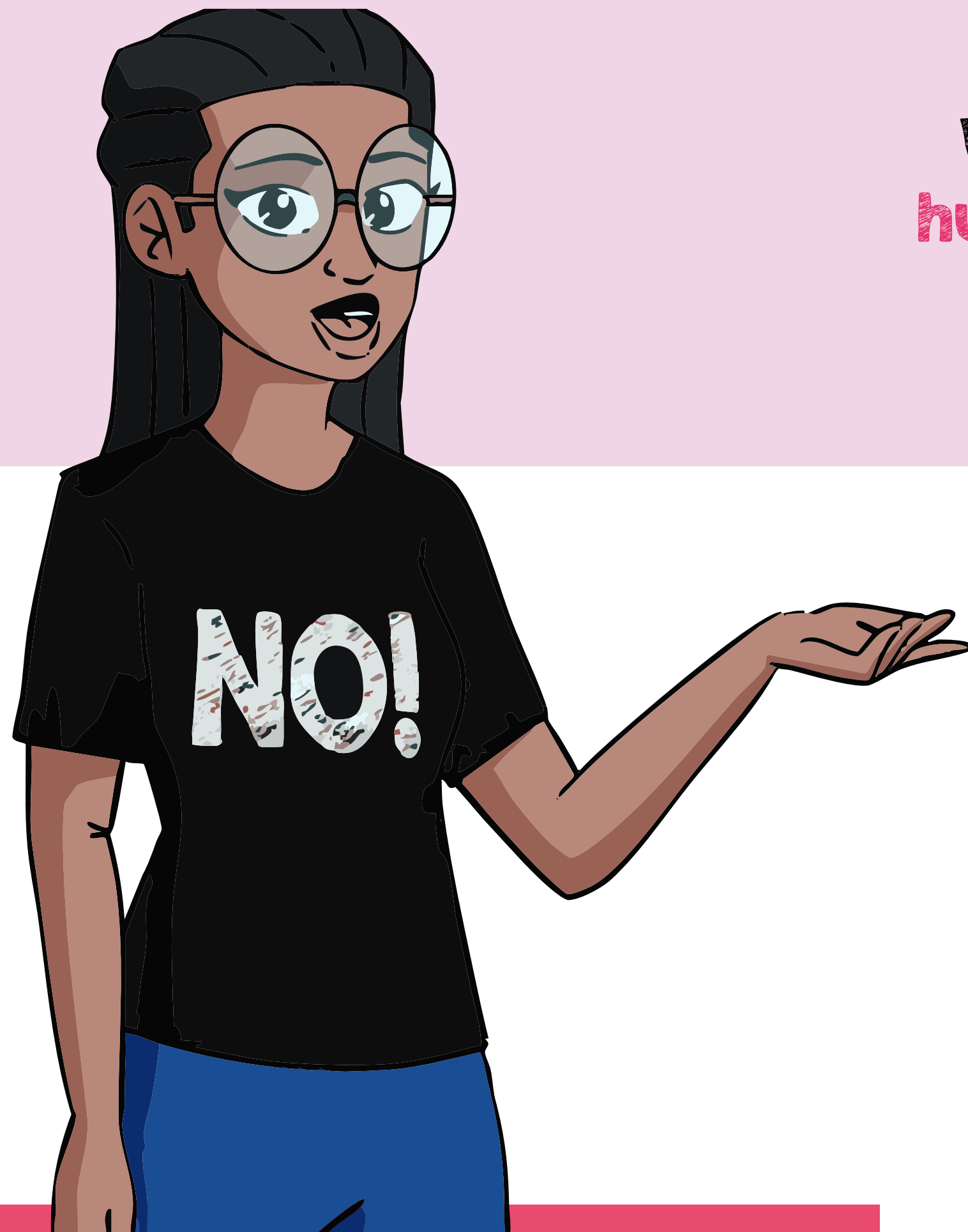
Self-defense

Self-defense is anything you Do, Say or believe that helps you keep safe.

Self Defense can be running, crossing the street to avoid confrontation, lying or closing the doors.

We use GESD when someone is trying to hurt us emotionally, mentally or physically.

We are worth defending and have the right to do so and believe anything that keeps us safe.

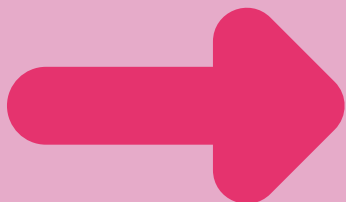


Attack Progression Scale

Shows the full range of attacks, ranging from mildly irritating to life threatening.



Defines and shows all types of attacks



ATTACK PROGRESSION SCALE



IRRITATING

LIFE THREATENING

Purpose of Attack Progression Scale

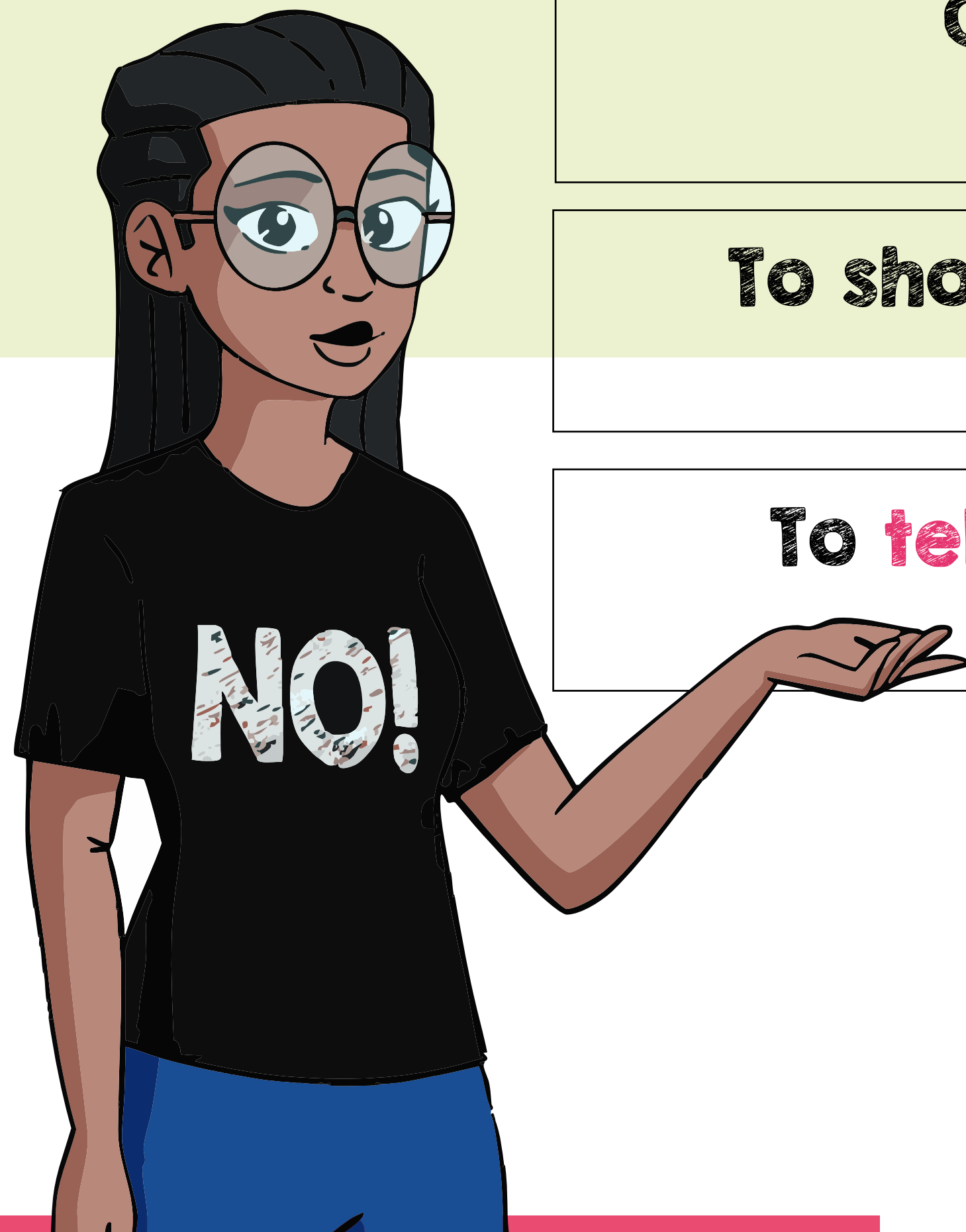
To define attacks and show all forms of attack. Normal attacks happening to one **does not mean it is okay.**

One can use their voice effectively to **stop almost any attack.**

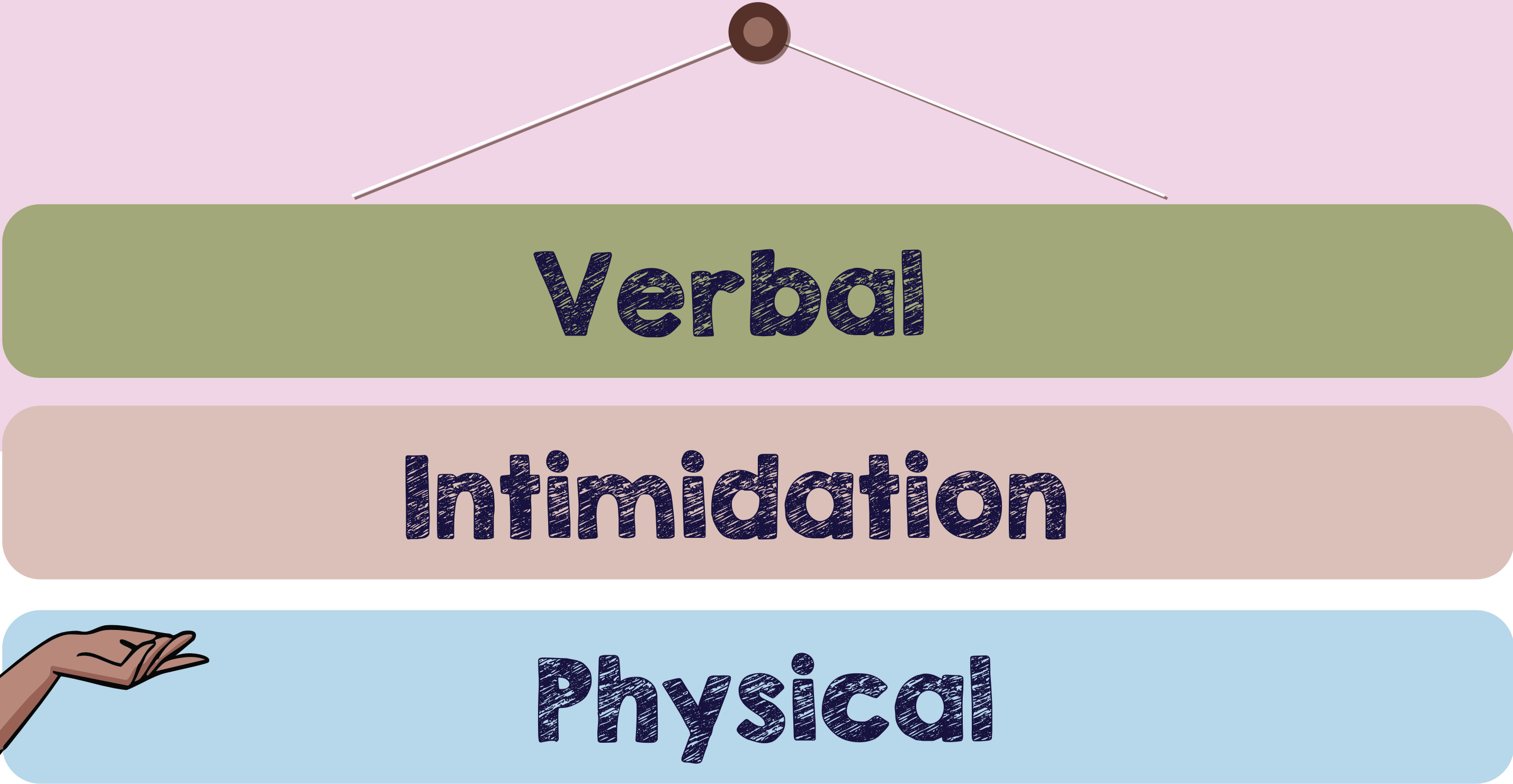
To show various ways to **defend yourself** if any attack happens to you.

To **tell someone** if any attack ever happens to you.

**It is never okay to be hurt.
It is never your fault.
You deserve to be safe.**



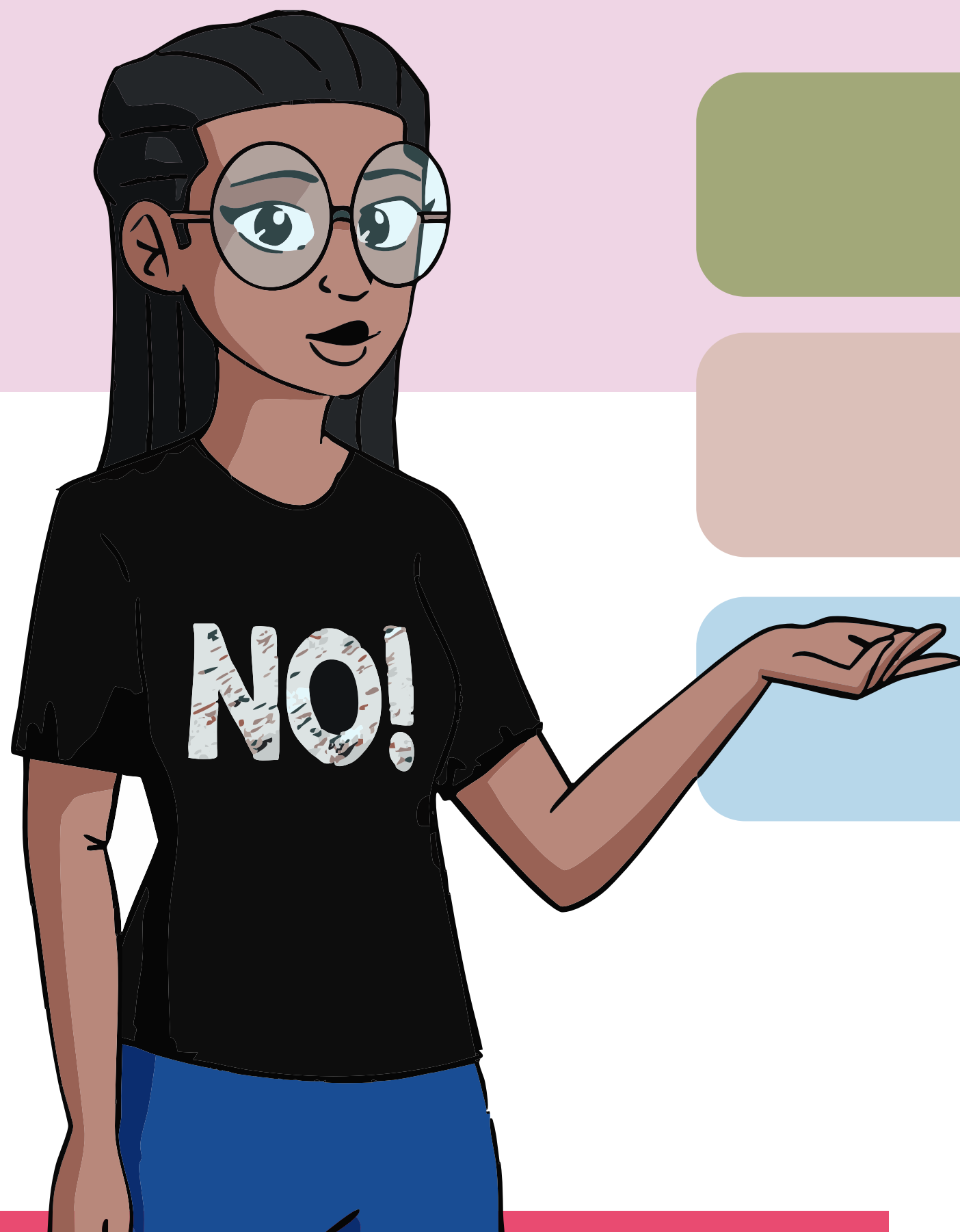
Three Types of Attacks



Verbal

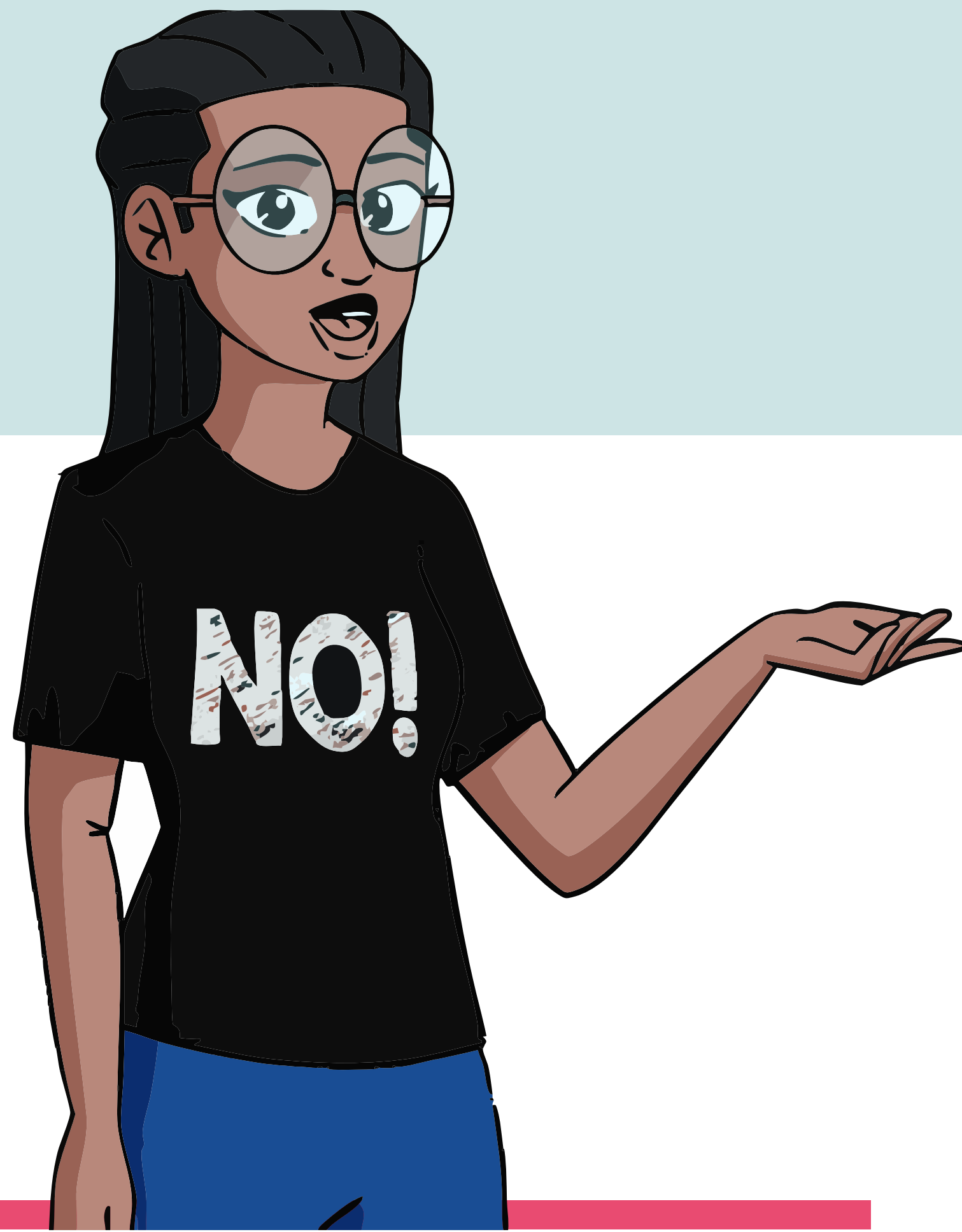
Intimidation

Physical



Verbal

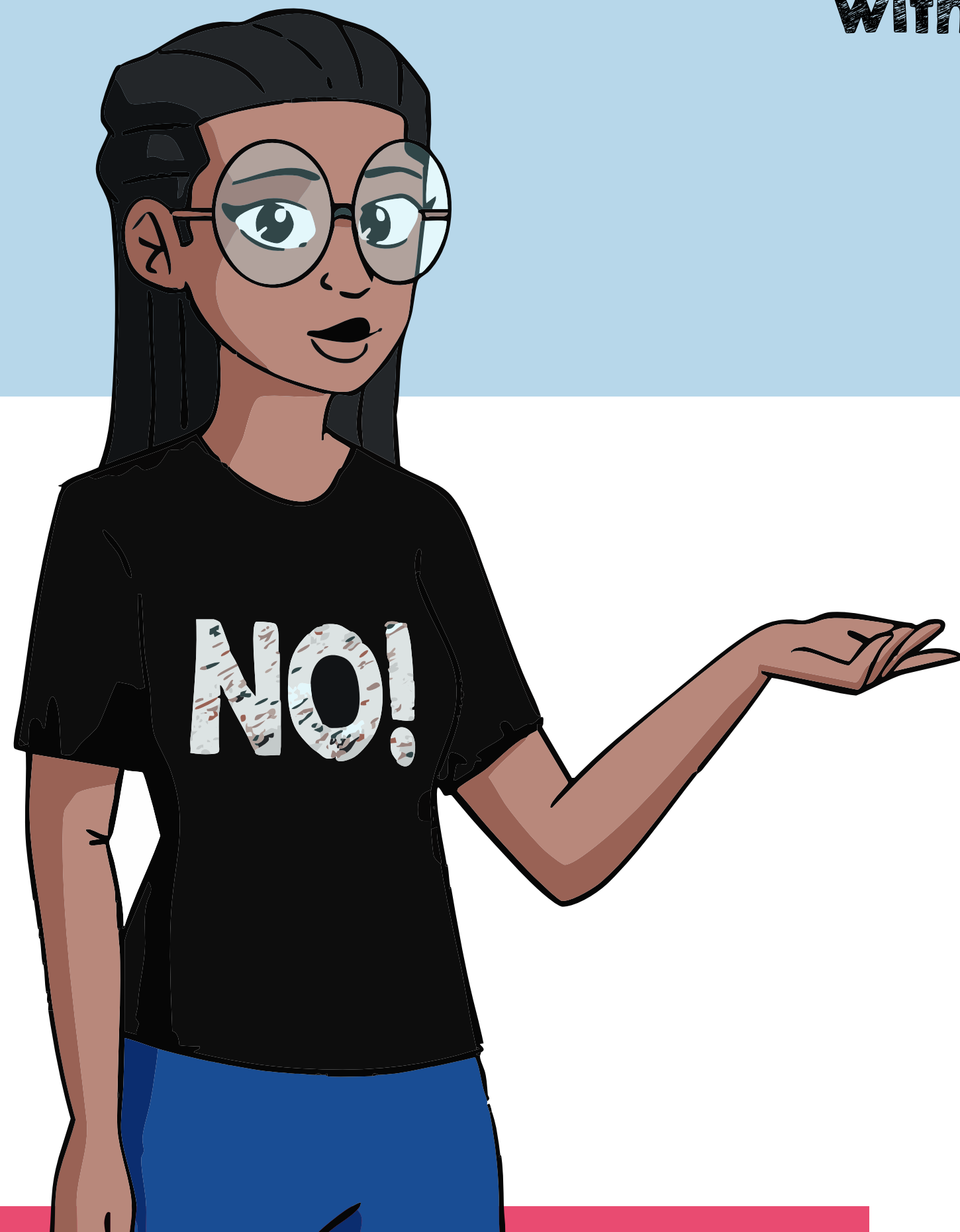
These are attacks where someone is using their words to hurt you.



Intimidation

This is when someone is using threats and actions to hurt you.

They may not touch you but they are inflicting fear with their voice or body to control your response.

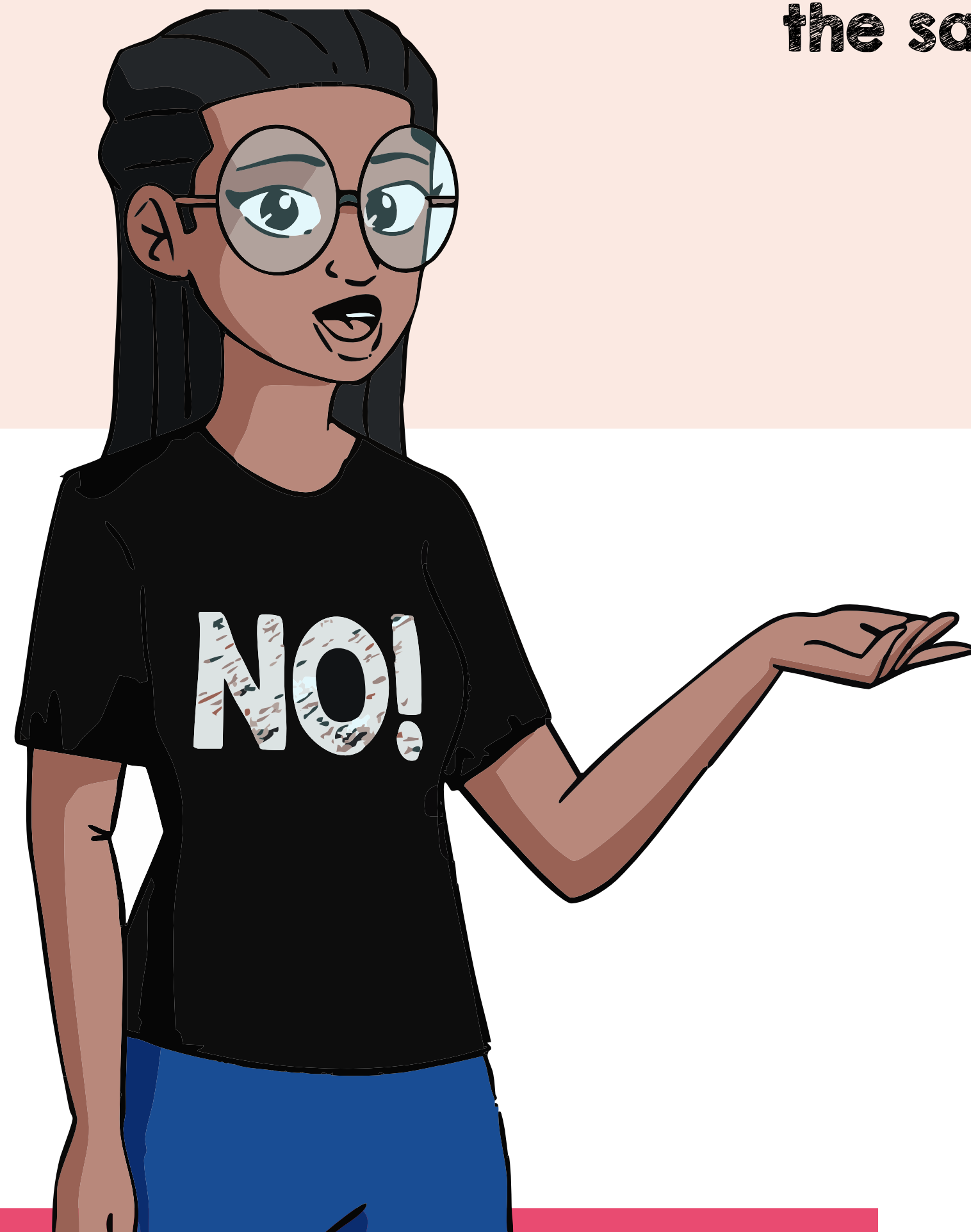


Physical

This is where the attacker has touched you and may mean to do you harm.

It is not okay for someone to touch you without your consent.

You have the right to protect yourself with the same level of response including **physical force.**



Attack Progression Scale

Important points

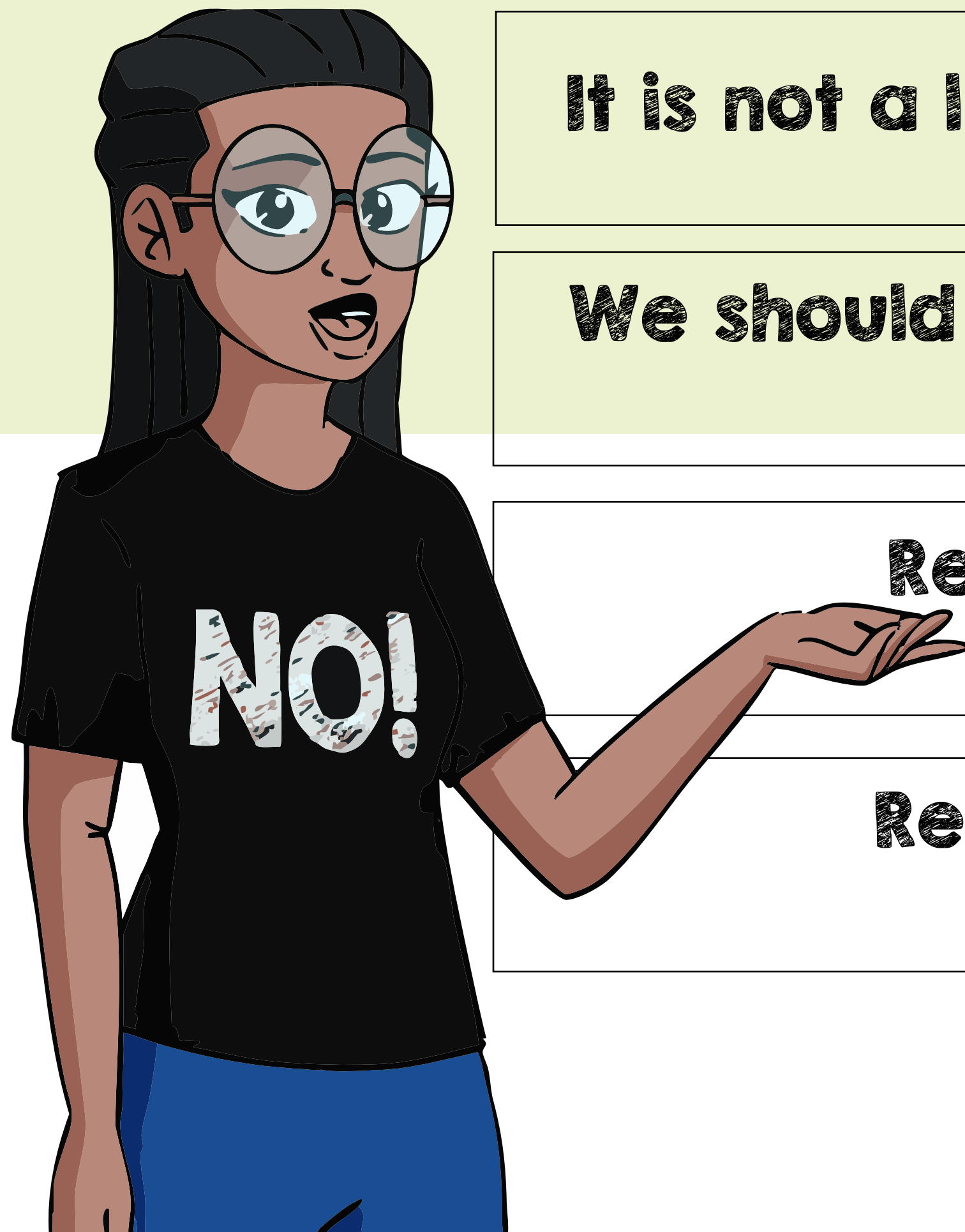
It is divided into three parts: Verbal, Intimidation and Physical

It is not a linear path: attacks can happen from in any order.

We should stop attacks where they start. We dont want to escalate the situation.

Response to attacks can differ depending on who is doing the assault.

Response to attacks can differ depending on the condition of the attacker.



Uses of Voice

85% of assaults can be stopped by the use of voice and 15% by the use of physical skills.

Voice is very important in ending a conflict.

When we use our voice effectively, we avoid having a fight.



Here are some of the uses of voice

Naming the behavior



Yelling No



Here are some of the uses of voice

Negotiating



Calling for help

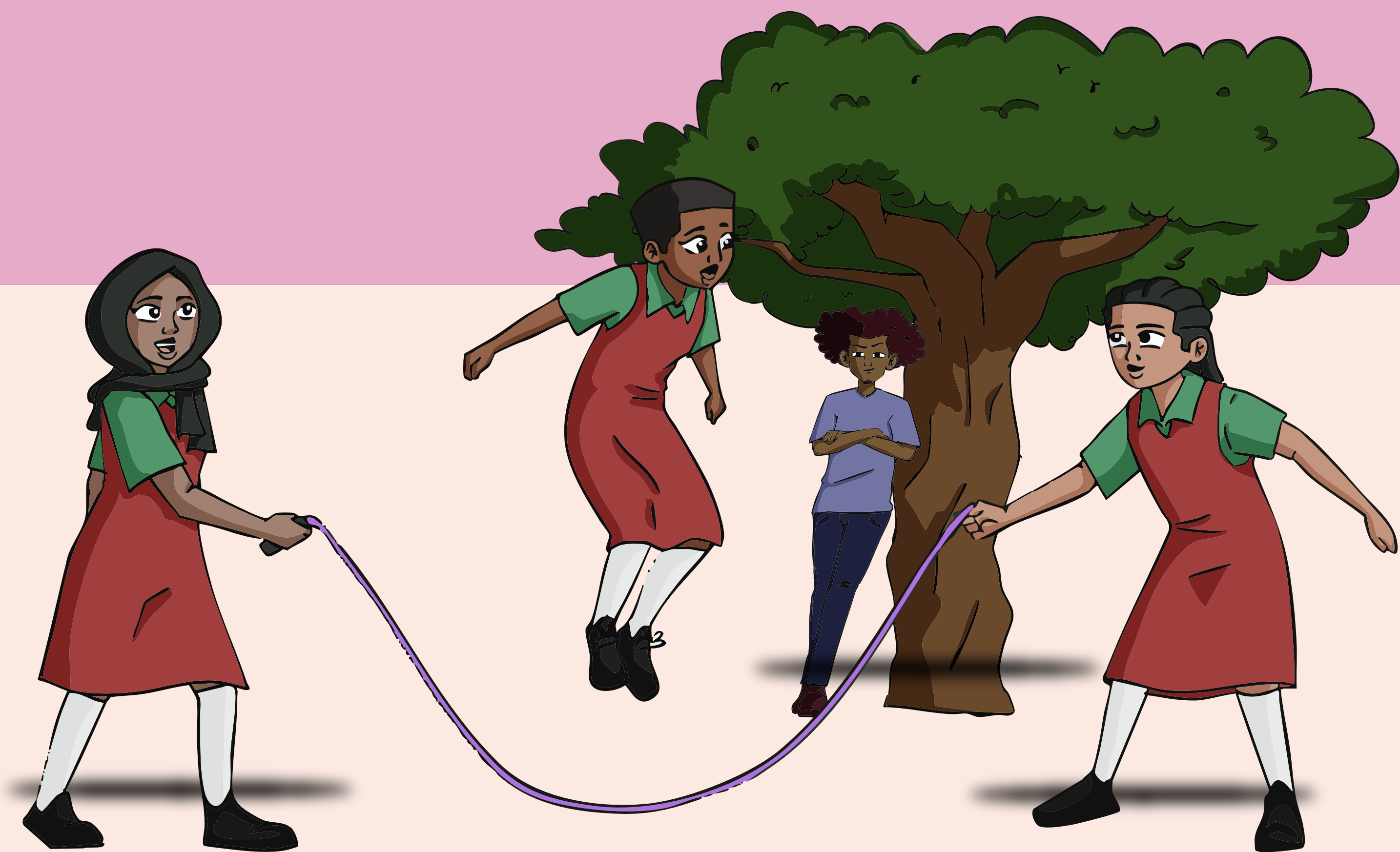


SESSION 2

Perpetrator Progression Pattern (PPP)

This is the pattern that the attacker uses and its called the Identification, selection and attack.

Many attackers have planned the attack for a while, sometimes even for years.



Identification

Identification happens in secret and often times we do not know we are being targeted for an attack. The attacker is looking for an easy victim, someone **vulnerable (weak, old, drunk, or young)** who is easily intimidated, manipulated, or unlikely to be believed if they tell about the attack.



Selection

In this phase the attacker has made his choice and comes in close to assess the victim and see how she will respond. He will use **comments, questions, and conversations He can choose to be nice to get to know you better.**

He will use comments or conversations called **plays to see how you react and respond.**

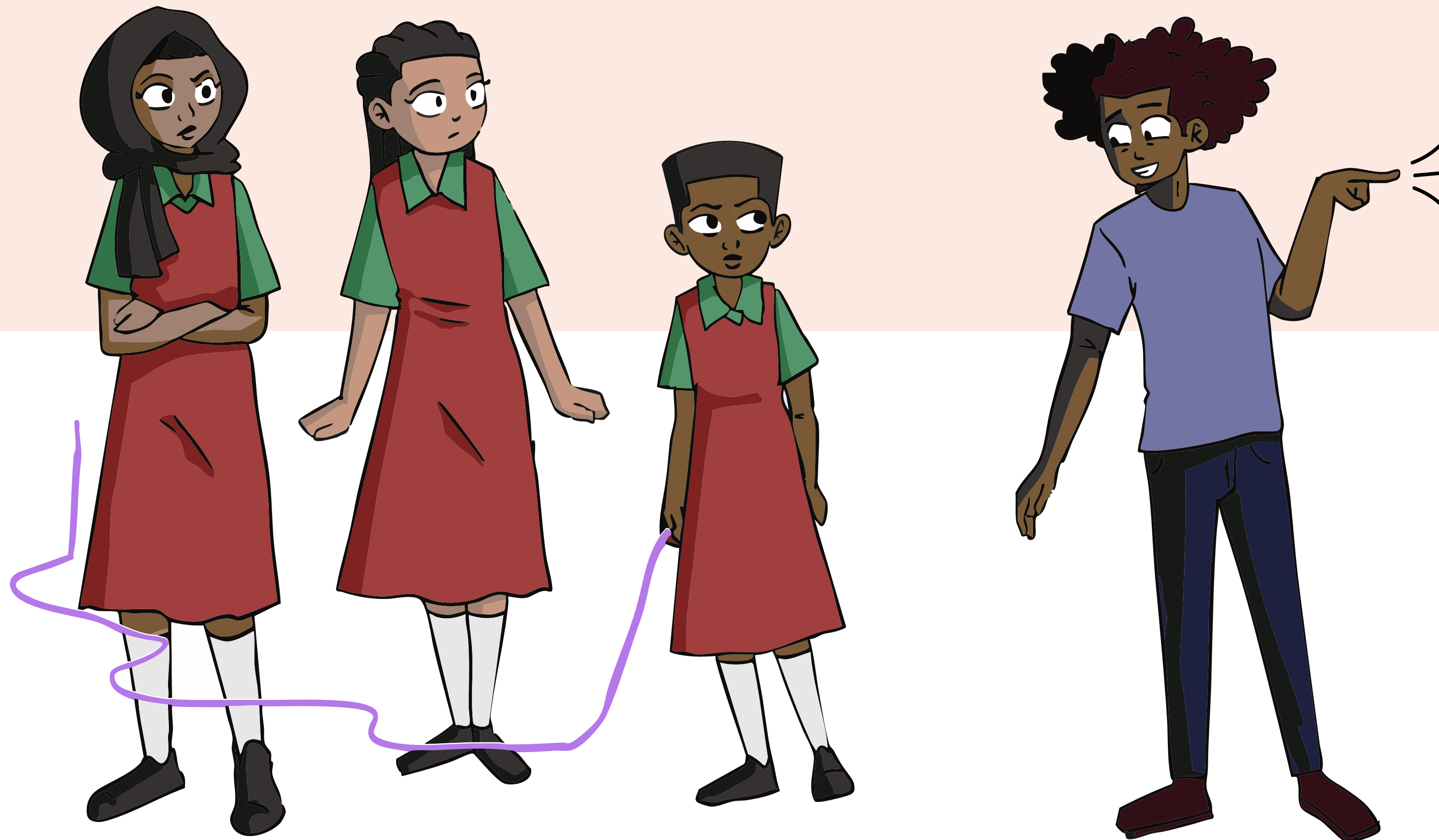
Are you shy, aggressive, or annoyed?

Are you uncomfortable around him or scared?

All these are clues to an attacker. He is looking to see if he can hurt you without anyone finding out.

Ploys

These are conversations or actions attackers use to get **close and size us up for attack. By getting us to interact with him, the attacker gets clues about how we react and respond.**

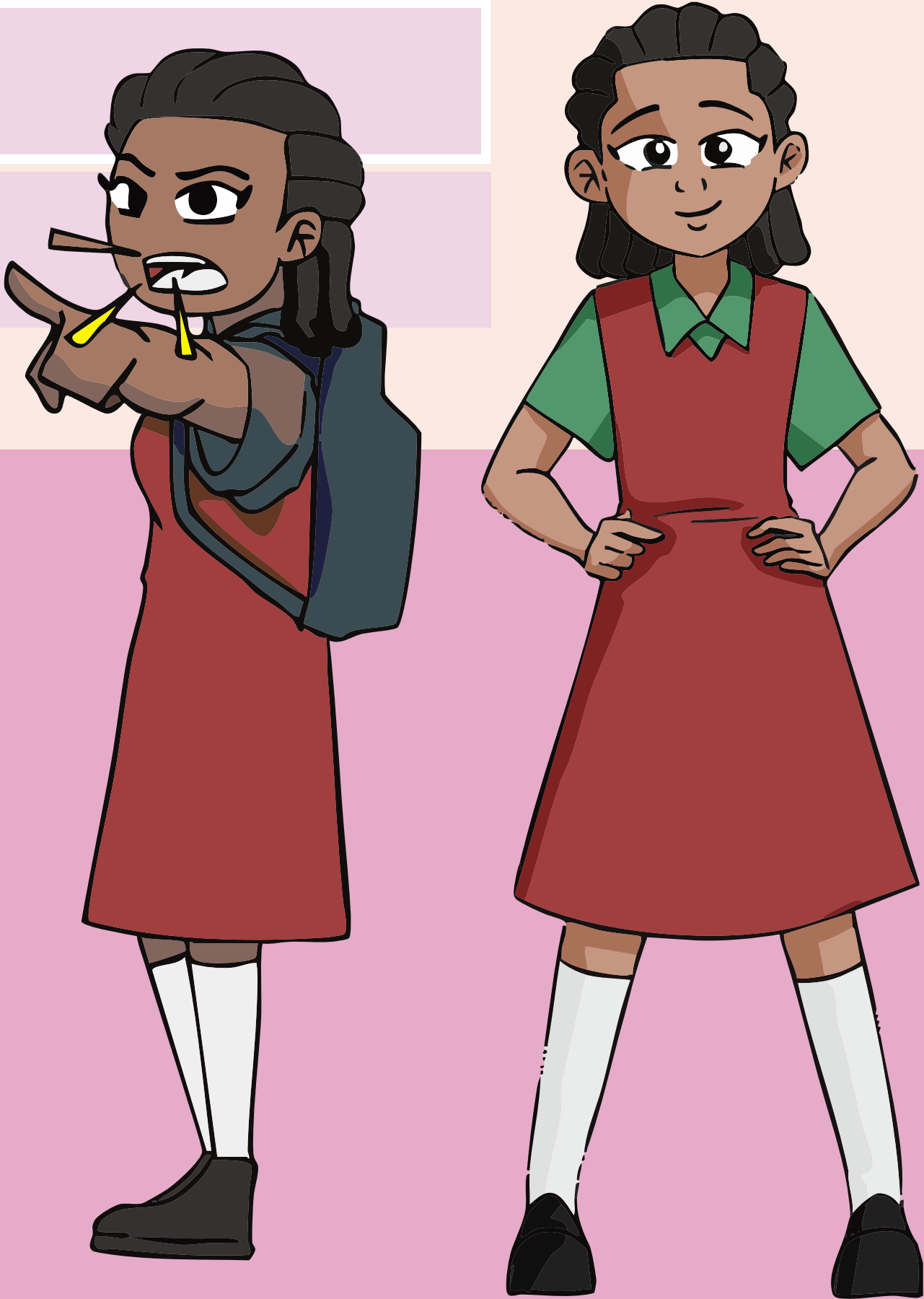


Responding to ploys

Be firm and assertive– Every opinion matters.

You don't have to be nice

Put a “Don't mess with me!” attitude



Attack Process

This is the **most dangerous stage**, they will only get to this stage if you have proved to be an easy/vulnerable victim.

The attacker may use **threats and intimidation** to position you for the attack.
He may tell you he will kill you if you scream or that he has a gun or knife.



SESSION 3

Awareness

Awareness simply means **being alert and paying attention** to what is going on around us and what we are feeling inside.

Awareness prevents perpetrators progression patterns.



The Gazelle Story



The four visible signs of awareness

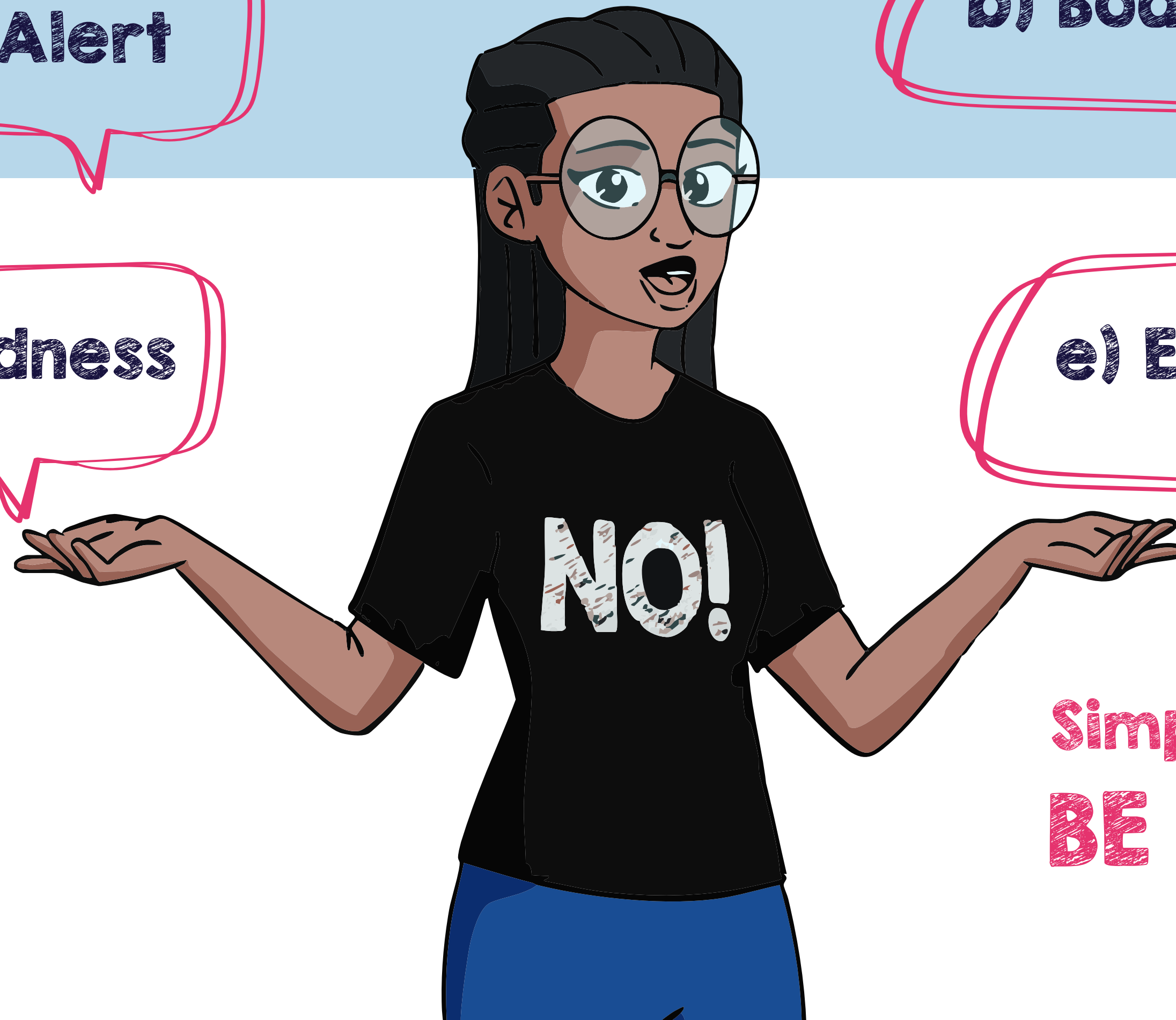
There are many ways to be aware. We don't have to change our whole personality to be an aware person.

a) Alert

b) Body Language

c) Loudness

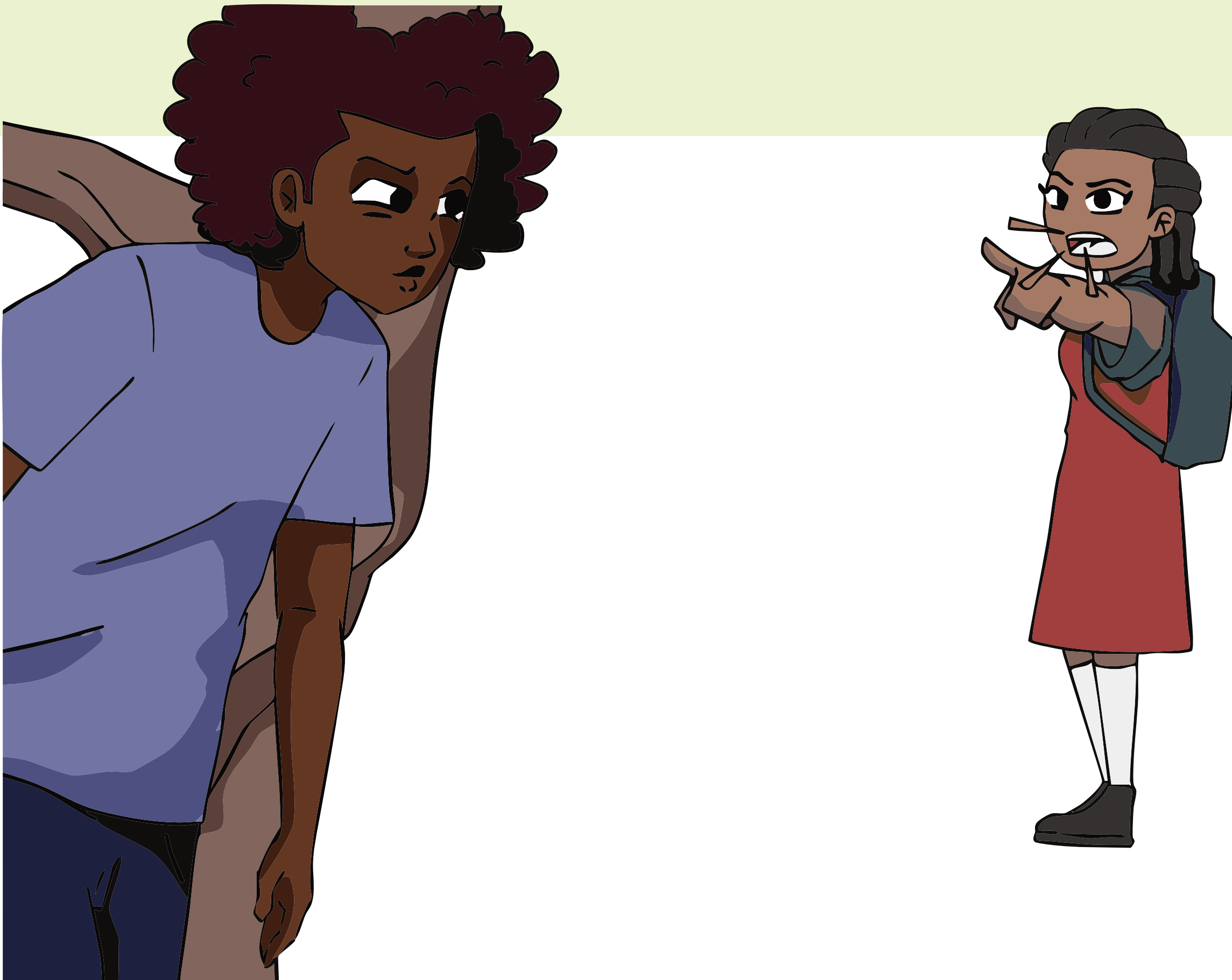
e) Eye-Contact



Simple rule of awareness is
BE and ACT AWARE

a) Alert

Pay attention to the **message and the clues** coming in. If you get comfortable try to get to a **safe place**.



b) Body language

Strong body posture, stand tall, head up, shoulders back and walk confidently.



e) Eye-contact

Eye contact alone can end targeting. It says “I’m **paying attention** and you can’t make me scared.”



c) Loudness

Have a **confident voice** in speaking up, not mumbling. Showing you’re **not afraid** to **call for attention**.



Inner Voice

It's the inner voices, feelings, or thoughts that warns us of danger

When something doesn't seem right, awareness picks up the warning and sends a message to inner voice, which measures the danger and alerts us.

We all receive inner voices messages in different ways like



Hear a voice

Feel a chill

Have a feeling

How we experience inner voice

Inner voice can bring both positive and negative news

We experience positive intuitive messages as a feeling of wonder, a smile, a voice while negative messages as a sense of fear, worry, a feeling that something is wrong.

We receive danger signals from Inner voice through:

A) Mind

Some people hear sounds, voices, or thoughts



B) Body

Blood runs cold, skin tingles, warmth or coldness



C) Emotion

**Fear, sadness, suspicion, worry
doubt, hurt**



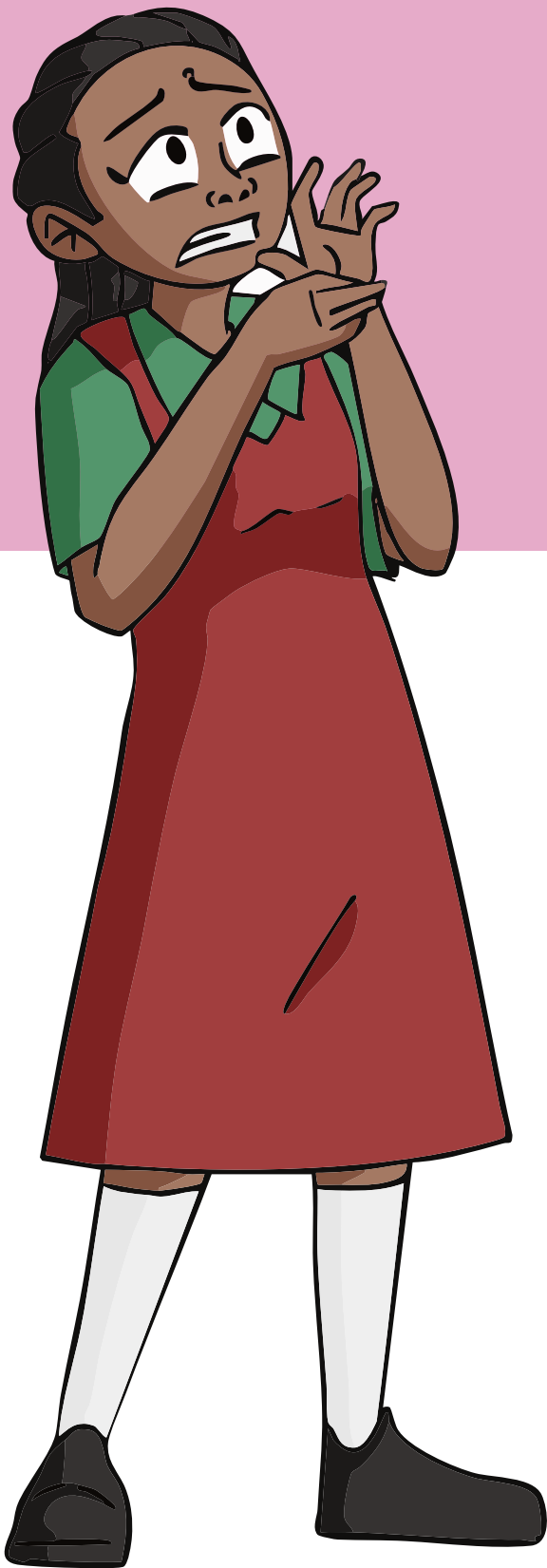
D) Spirit

**Senses (it fills the body with impulses
to do or change something, even though there
may be no logical reason for it.**



Messengers of inner voice

1. Fear



2. Doubt



3. Worry



4. Gut Feeling



5. Nagging Thoughts



Messengers of denial

These are thoughts in our minds that excuse and deny the warnings of inner voice

Just like there are messengers of inner voice, there are also messengers of denial.



**Denying our inner voice is dangerous
and can cost us our lives**

Messengers of denial

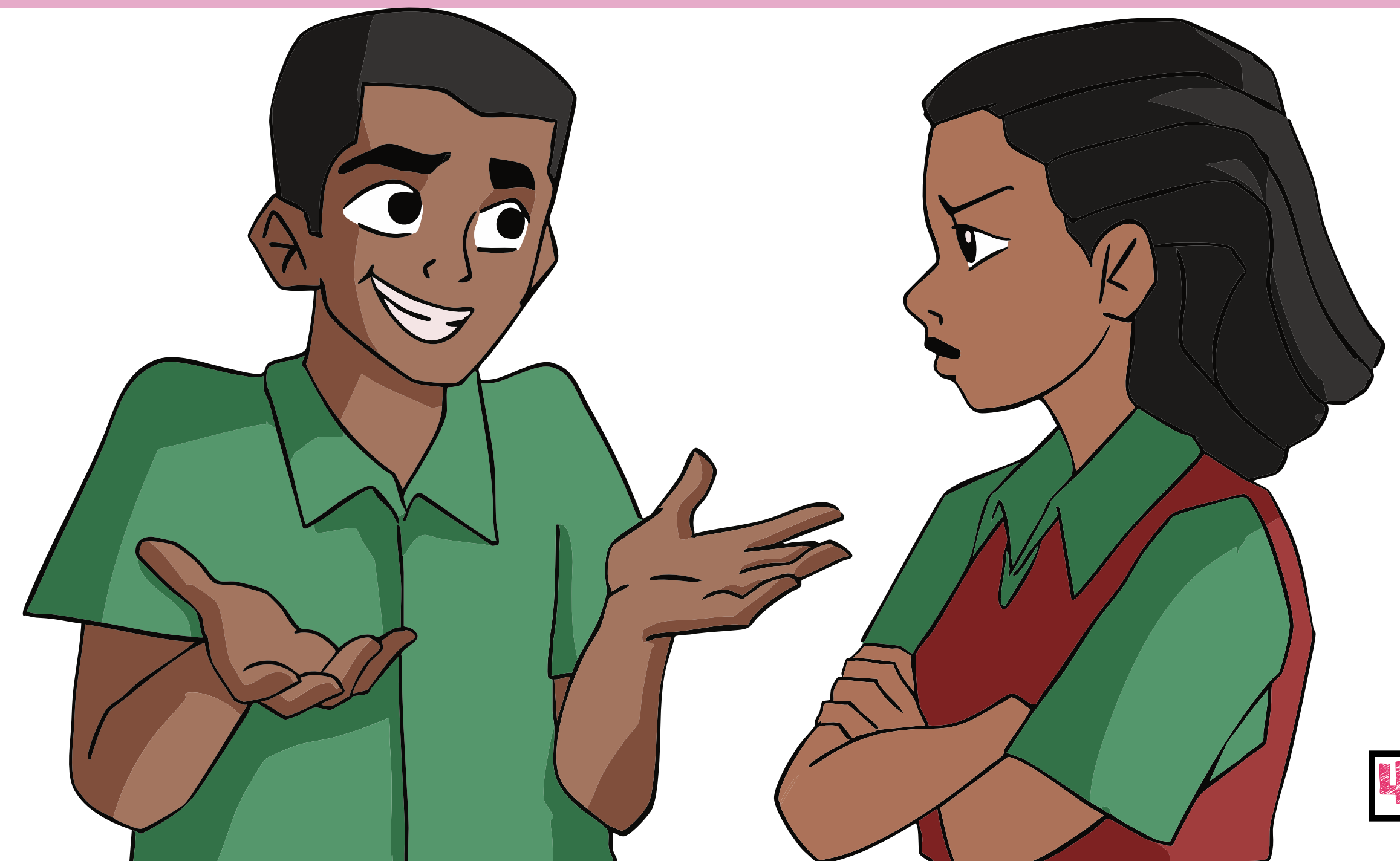
1. Rationalization

“I have gone out with him before and nothing happened.” Rationalizing a creepy feeling



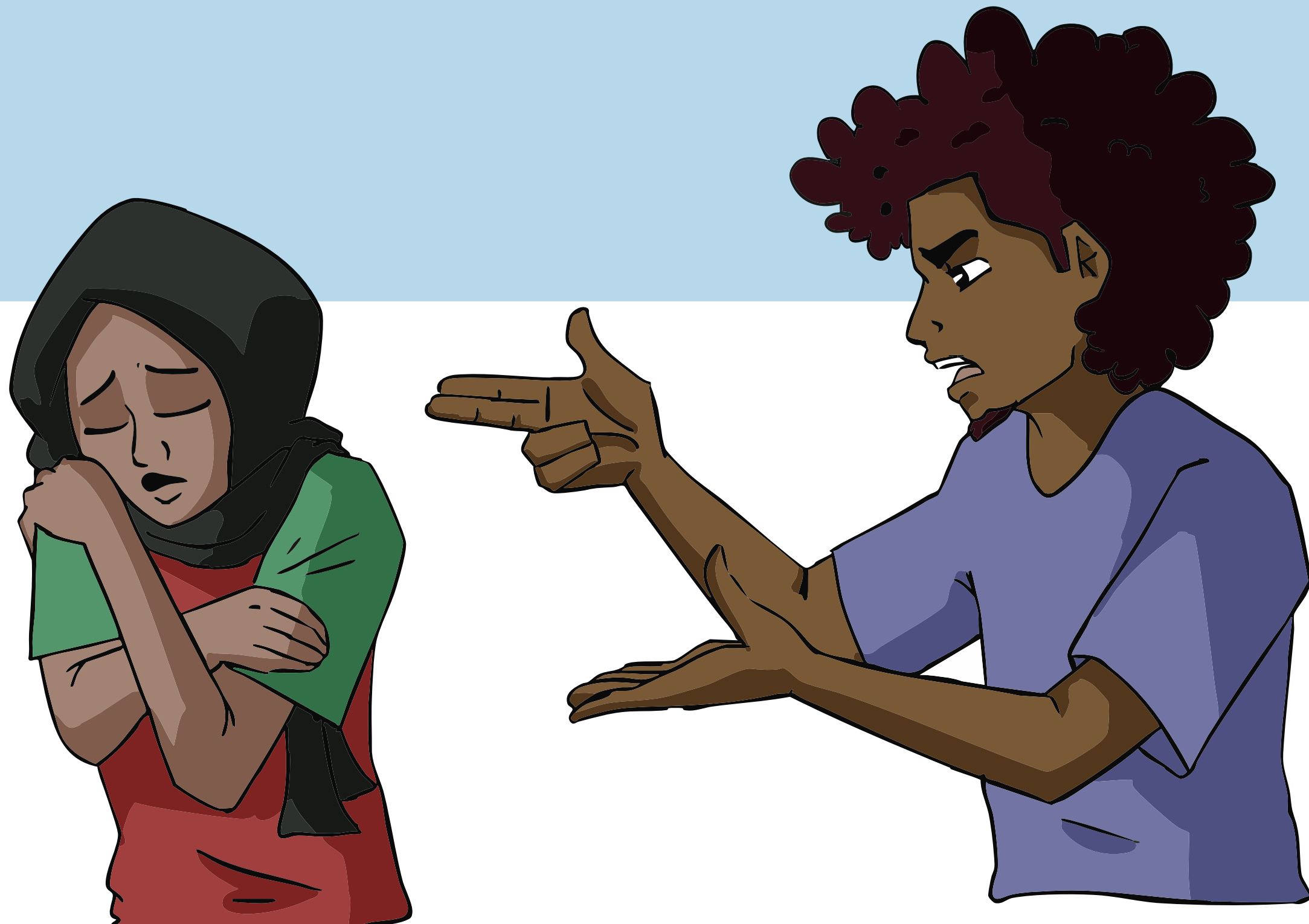
2. Justification

“I made him angry. I have to stop being so difficult.” You’re justifying a temper outburst.



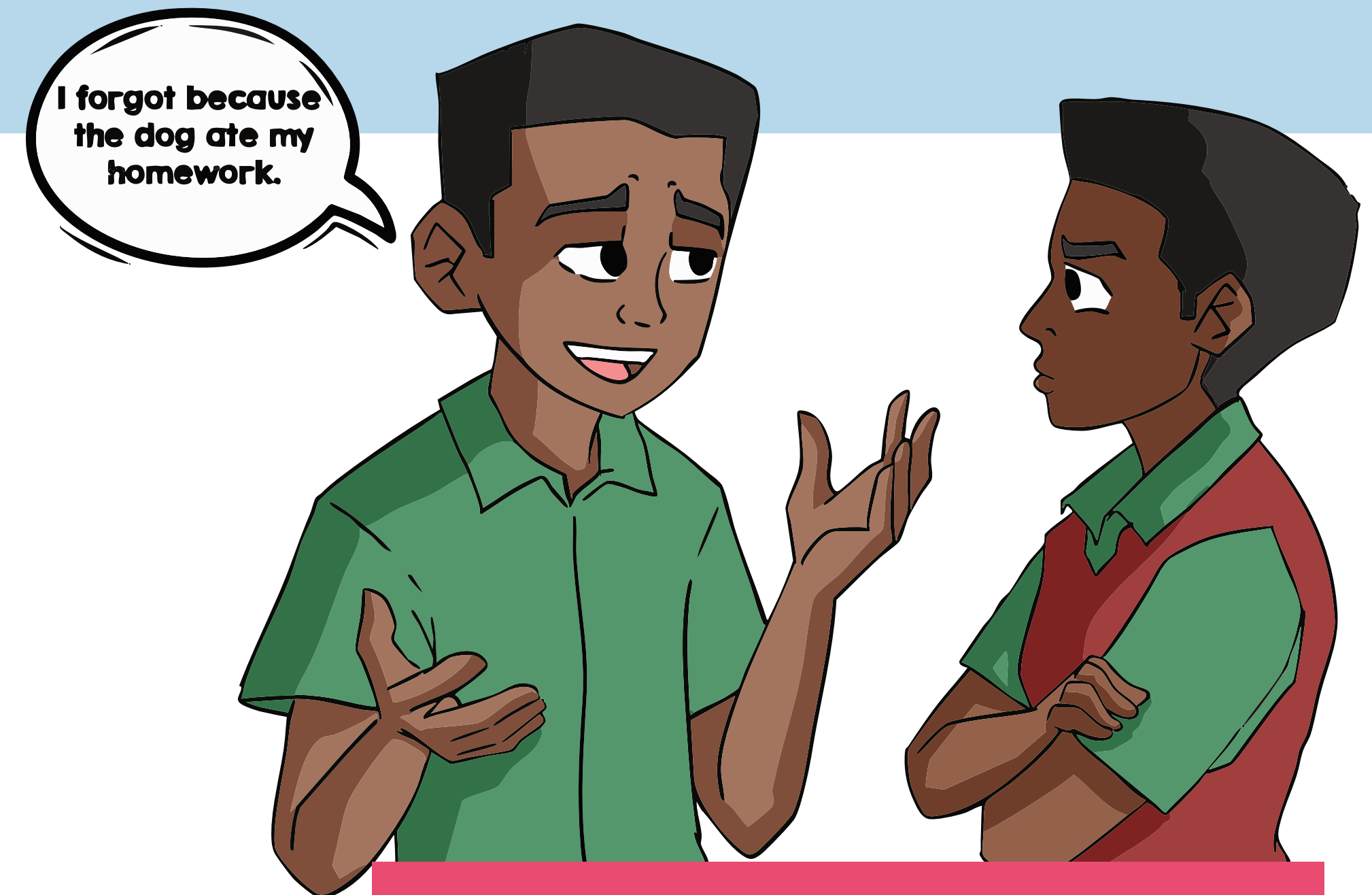
3. Minimization

“It’s not that big of a deal. He promised he would be nicer.” You’re minimizing name calling and put downs



4. Excuse Making

“Boys will be boys.” You’re making excuse for a bad behaviour or disrespect



5. Ridiculing

**“I am just being a baby about this.”
You’re ridiculing the concerns you have**



USE THIS AS A CHEER TO
END THE SESSION

Five Bodily Weapons (SMEVB)

The (SMEVB) are five bodily weapons which are always with us. When used together they increase our chances of successfully resisting an attack of any Kind.

Spirit

I am worth defending



Mind

Helps me strategize



Eyes

I can see you



Voice

I can Yell No!



Body

I am beautiful, I am Dangerous
Dont get me Started!



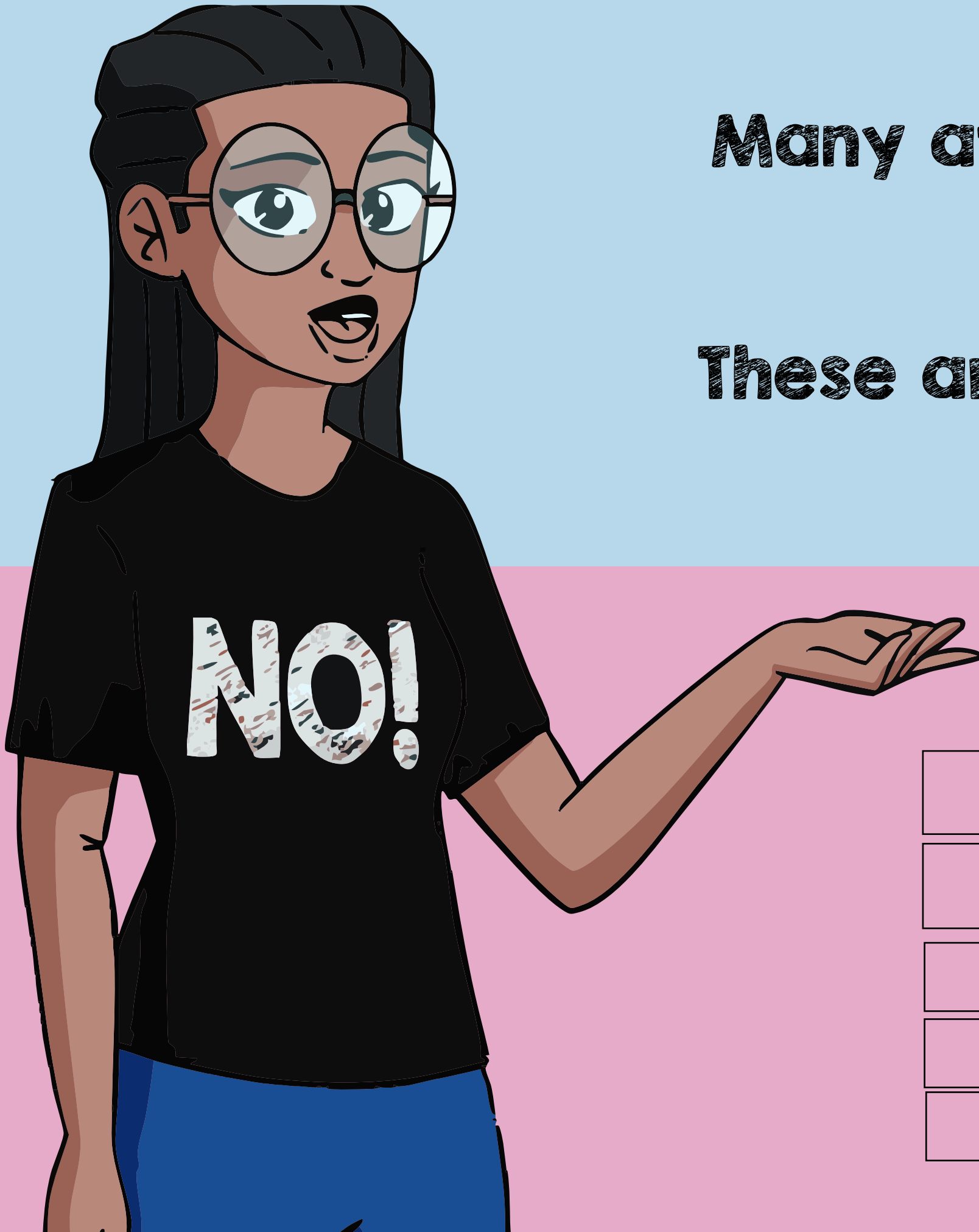
SESSION 4

Verbal Safety Toolbox

Is the way we can use our voices to prevent attack

Many attacks can be stopped by using our **voices and body language**

These are dozens of **verbal strategies, skills and ideas** to use in an attack situation.



Saying NO effectively

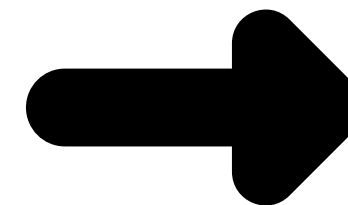
Saying NO effectively means a strong voice, eye contact and strong body posture.

When we agree to do something that is not right for us, it can lower our self-esteem

Make eye contact

Keep a serious face

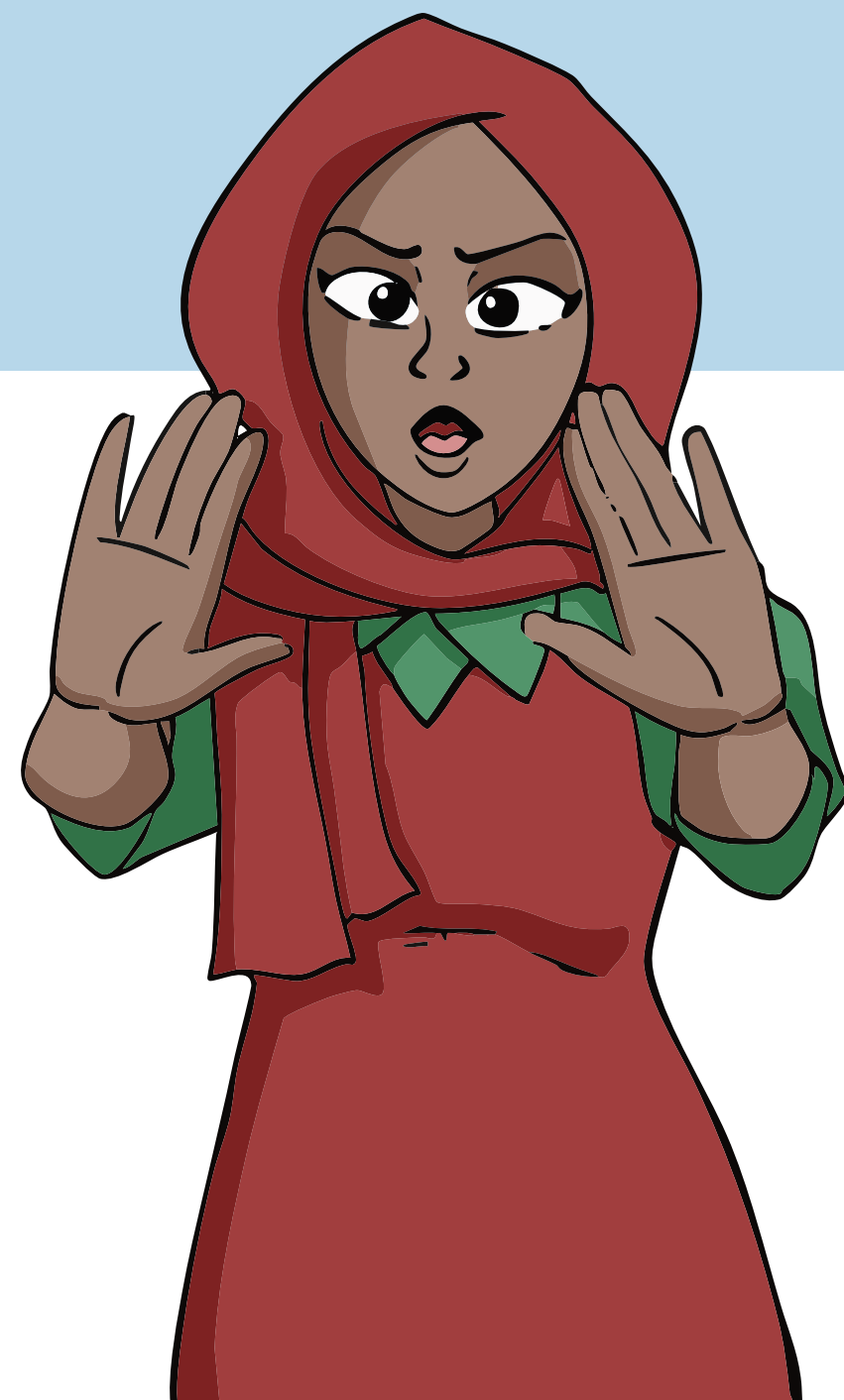
Speak with an assertive voice



Stance and yell

A fighting stance is used to establish a **strong position** from which to fight.

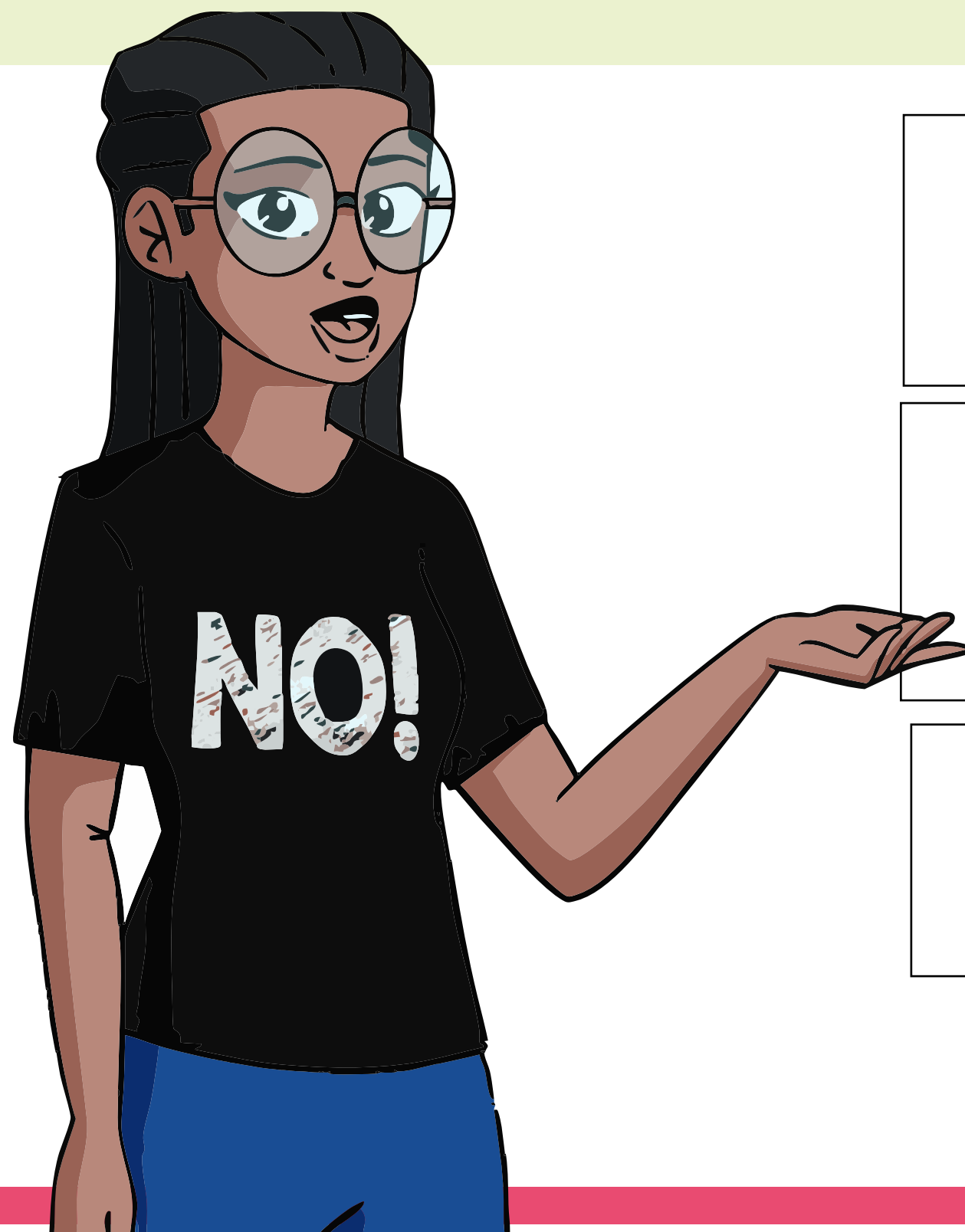
To get to the fighting stance, **place one foot back and bend your knees**. Put your elbows with your palm up facing out this is the universal sign for **“NO”** or **“STOP”**



Assertiveness

Is knowing what we need or want to happen and saying it clearly

Assertiveness is the response we want to have in a **conflict** whenever possible. When being assertive, it is important to **make eye contact** and have a **strong body language**.



Aggressive response: Bullying others to get your way, taking things without asking, making threats, using angry voice, or demanding things

Passive response: Not asking for what you want, expecting others to read your mind, doing things you don't want because you can't say **NO** then being secretly resentful

Assertive response: This is our best chance at **ending a conflict**, being direct, getting right to the point, no confusing words or sentence, saying clearly

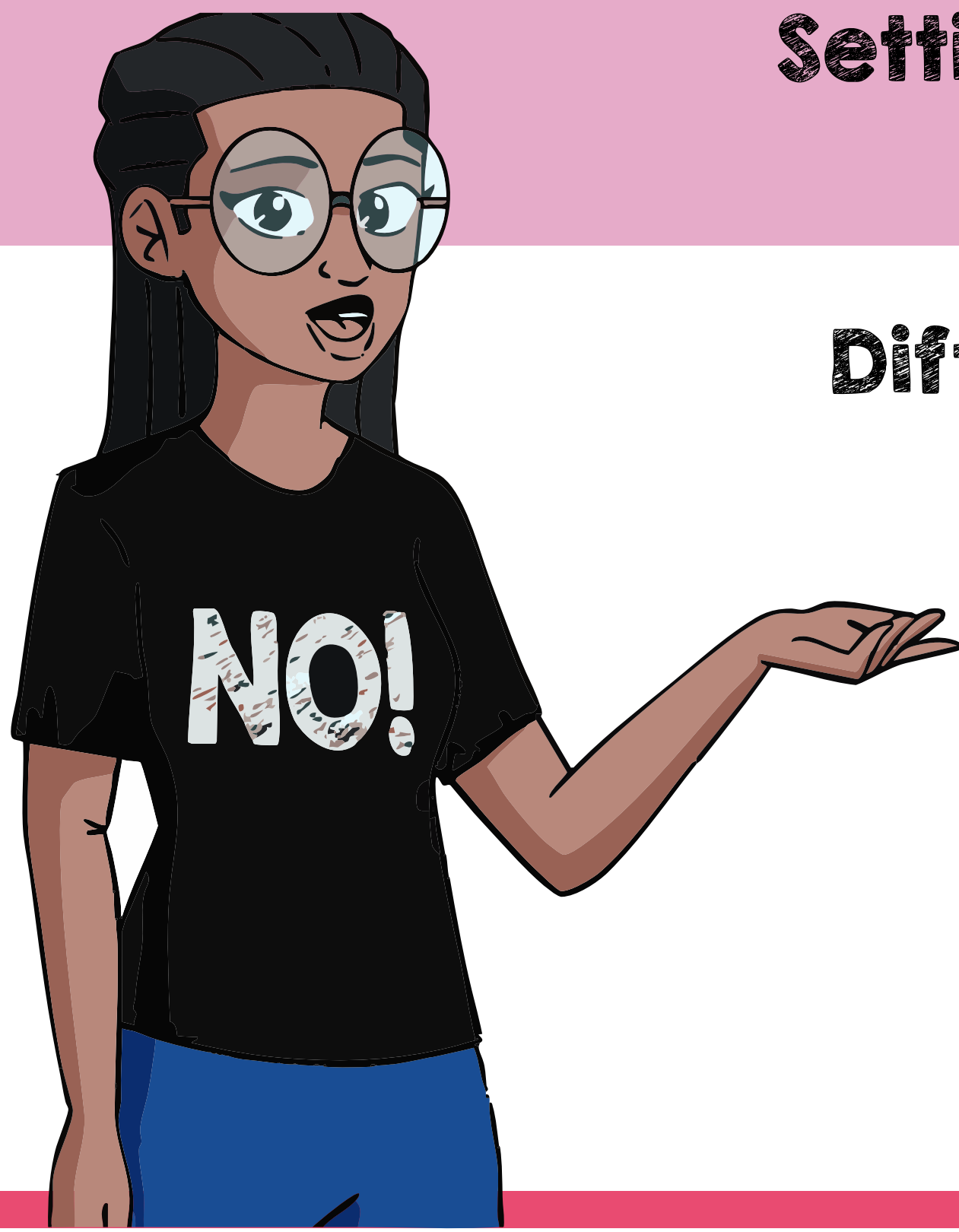
Boundaries

**These are the rules we set for how we want to be treated
boundaries tell others how they may speak or act towards us.**

When we use **assertiveness to speak up for ourselves
we are infact setting boundaries.**

**Setting boundaries may be difficult but it is necessary
and worth it if we want **healthy relationships****

Different ways we can use to defend our boundaries



Naming the behaviour

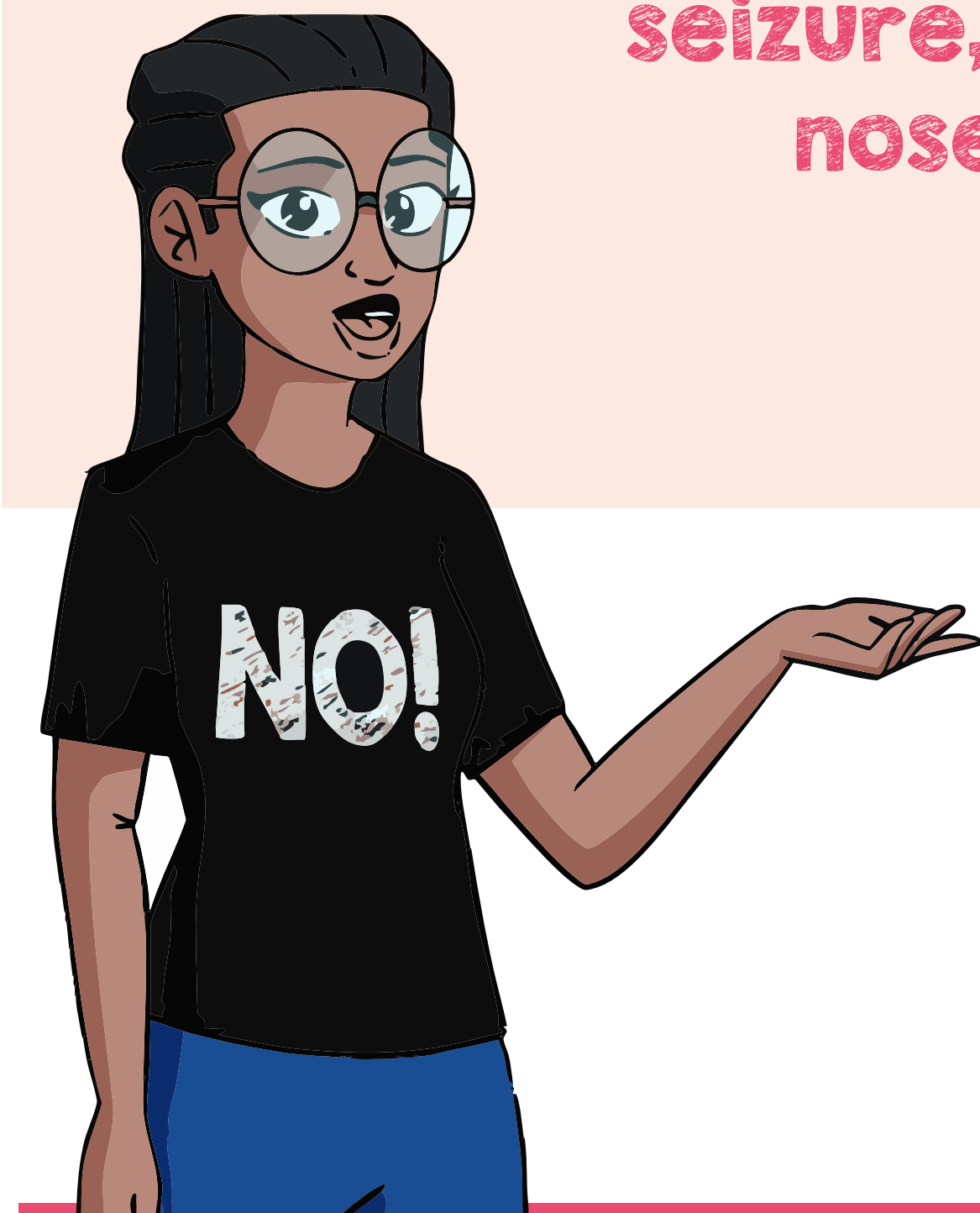
Making a scene

Tantrums

A sudden fit/burst of rage/ temper and resistance

Tantrums revolves around three strategies that can surprise, confuse and disturb an **attacker.**

Things you can do to throw a tantrum include **urinate, pretend to have a seizure, talk to an imaginary friend, dance with the attacker, pick your nose tell him you have a disease, make him believe you are God**



**REMEMBER TO MAINTAIN
CONFIDENTIALITY IN
THIS SESSION.**

Breaking The Silence

This is telling on someone who is hurting you.

Breaking the silence gives someone hopes and courage to talk about something they have not talked about before or for a long period of time.



**It encourages sharing
with anyone they trust that they
have been attacked, harrassed
or abused.**



Important Points

The abuse or attack is **not your fault**

Don't live in fear, get **tested**. You can be **treated**

You can tell of what happened to you in **private**
You don't have to do it in public

Sometimes the abuser is a family member, neighbour
or cousin. No one should assault, harm or threaten you

**You are not alone. Many women and girls have been
attacked before and have gotten help**

**You can intervene for someone you may know or
care about, who is in trouble**

**You are worth
Defending.**



De-escalation And Negotiation

De-escalation is a skill used to stop a volatile situation from getting worse

Negotiation is a skill we use to bargain for a better deal to avoid escalating conflicts

We may start with de-escalation to calm down the aggressor so that negotiation can take place



Elements of De-escalation

Calmness

**Neutral body
language**

**Eye
contact**

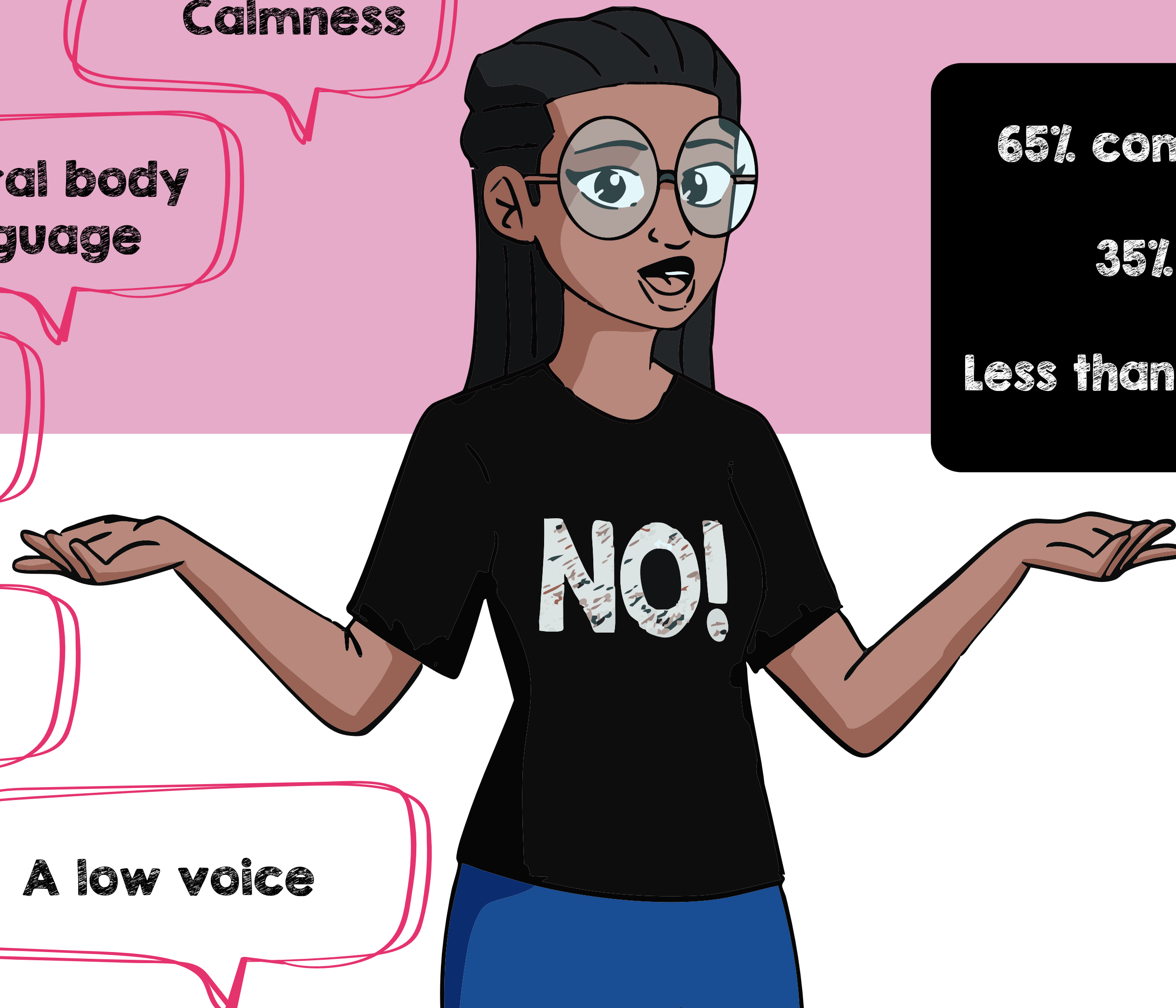
**Acknowledge
anger**

A low voice

65% communication is non verbal

35% is pitch and loudness

Less than 10% is our choice of words



How to De-escalate

Start out by matching the other person's level of intensity, then bring it down

Offer options, alternatives and apology if it will help cool things down

Stand at an angle to the other person. Don't stand directly in front of them

Acknowledge the other person's anger

Keep an emotional distance and react calmly to whatever they are saying

Suggest moving to another space to work on resolving the situation

When and Why to De-escalate



To avoid physical confrontation

When there is more than one attacker

When you feel threatened

If the person is a close friend or family member

If you are in an abusive relationship

When the attacker is mentally ill, drunk or high

USE THIS AS A CHEER TO
END THE SESSION

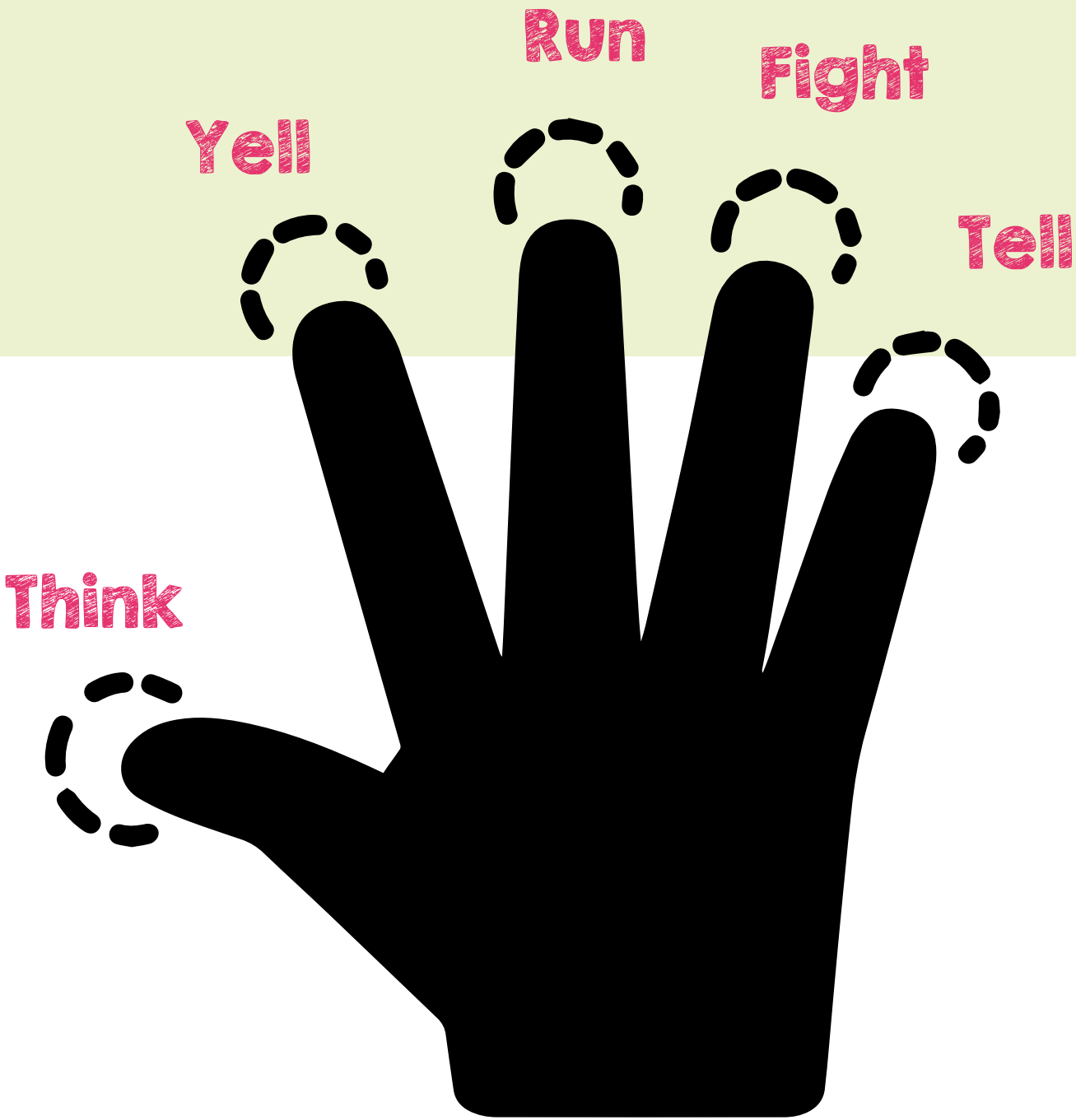
Five Fingers of Emergency

This is defined as emergency self defense tools that girls use incase they need to get away fast.

Girls use the five fingers of emergency tools
incase of an emergency and they need to know the fast way
to escape harm.



Think
Yell
Run
Fight
Tell



Five Fingers of Emergency

Think

Stay calm and think
how to respond



Yell

Use your strongest loudest voice
to yell NO!, STOP, LET GO! or BACK OFF!



Five Fingers of Emergency

Run

Get away and run if you can



Fight

**If you need to fight do
What's FREE, what's OPEN**



Tell

**Tell,Tell,Tell
until you get the
help you need**

